Islands VA

SUPPORT, DAY AND NIGHT

DESIGN SYSTEM · TEAM GUIDE

Support, day and night.

Foundations, components, patterns and implementation for the Islands VA website, blog and client dashboard.

Version 1.2 · October 13, 2026

Live system: claude.ai/artifact/Ha5kSyvZ7axkKvVYjupvpK

ISLANDS VA DESIGN SYSTEM

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INTRODUCTION

Start here

Islands VA is a virtual assistant agency whose promise is in its tagline: **Support, day and night.** This guide is the team's shared reference for building that promise into our marketing site, blog and client dashboard.

What's in the system

- Two themes, **Day** and **Night**, from one set of tokens
- Colour, type, spacing, radius, shadow, layout and z-index tokens
- 48 React components with live previews and guidelines
- Logos, icons and illustration rules
- Page examples: landing page, client dashboard, blog
- Accessibility and Next.js implementation guides

How to use this guide

- **Designers:** read Foundations (pp. 3–13), then the component pages for the screens you're designing
- **Developers:** skim Foundations, then the component pages and the Next.js chapter
- **Writers & marketers:** Voice & content, Logo use, Marketing and Blog
- The **live system** is the source of truth — this PDF is a snapshot of it

Live design system
https://claude.ai/artifact/Ha5kSyvZ7axkKvVYjupvpK — interactive previews of every component in both themes, the token files, logo downloads and the full guidelines. If the PDF and the live system ever disagree, the live system wins.

Three principles

1

Day and night, always

Every screen works in both themes, shows time in the client's zone, and treats round-the-clock coverage as the core of the product — the theme switch is never hidden.

2

Turquoise leads, orange punctuates

Roughly 60% calm neutral surfaces, 30% teal family for links, selection and secondary actions, 10% sunrise orange for the single main action on each view.

3

Tropical calm, not holiday

Soft, rounded shapes from the logo's arcs; warm and unhurried copy; island colour in accents and illustration — never at the cost of clarity, structure or contrast.

Versions

DATE	WHAT CHANGED
Oct 10, 2026	Foundations, Day/Night themes, core components (Button, NavBar, ServiceCard, Modal, form fields, DashboardShell, Grid, Icon)
Oct 11, 2026	Blog extension: ocean and sand tokens, four category tones, ten blog components, ocean Button variant
Oct 13, 2026	Feedback, navigation, dashboard & data, and marketing components; validated chart palette; page examples

FOUNDATIONS

Voice & content

A capable colleague who has already handled it. Professional, warm, unhurried — tropical calm, not holiday brochure.

How we write

- Write to the client as **you**; the agency speaks as **we**; a client's assistant is **your VA**.
- **Sentence case everywhere** — headings, buttons, labels, nav. Uppercase only for the eyebrow style, which echoes the logo tagline.
- Lead with the outcome, then the mechanism: "Your inbox is clear by 8 am" before "We triage email daily".
- Buttons are verb-first and specific: *Book a discovery call*, *Choose Executive*, *Request my team*.
- Errors say what happened and how to fix it, without blame: "That email doesn't look complete — try name@company.com."
- Numbers are concrete and honest: "Same-hour response target", not "lightning-fast".
- No exclamation marks in product UI; no emoji in UI copy.
- Time is shown in the client's time zone, naming the zone when it matters: "10 pm Manila / 10 am New York".

Instead of… write

INSTEAD OF	WRITE
~~Submit~~	Request my team
~~Your request has been successfully submitted!~~	Got it. Your VA will reply within the hour.
~~Error 422~~	Choose a start date to continue.
~~24/7 world-class support solutions~~	Support, day and night
~~Oops! Something went wrong.~~	We couldn't save your task. Check your connection and try again.
~~Click here to learn more~~	See how night-shift coverage works

Empty, loading and error states

CASE	EXAMPLE
First use	No tasks yet. Add your first and your VA will pick it up within the hour.
No results	No invoices match "Q3". Try a different search or clear the filter.
All done	Inbox zero. Nothing needs you right now.
Limit approaching	You've used 88% of this month's hours — 6 of 40 left until Oct 31.

FOUNDATIONS

Colour

Brand hues come straight from the logo and stay the same in both themes. Everything you build with uses the **semantic tokens**, which swap between Day and Night — so a component written once works in both.

Brand hues

Deep
`brand-deep`
`#0E3A45`

Lagoon
`brand-lagoon`
`#7DD3C9`

Reef
`brand-reef`
`#1BA39C`

Ocean
`brand-ocean`
`#1F6FA8`

Sunrise
`brand-sunrise`
`#FFB662`

Sun
`brand-sun`
`#FF8A5B`

Palm
`brand-palm`
`#3E7F4F`

Sand
`brand-sand`
`#F5E8D3`

Brand hues are for fills, illustration and data — not body text. Lagoon, sunrise, sun and reef never carry text on light grounds (1.4–3:1).

Rules of thumb

- **Primary action** = `action-primary` (sunrise) with `on-action-primary` (deep teal) text, 7.1:1. One per view.
- **Links and selection** = `action-secondary` / `link`: 5.4:1 or better on every Day surface, 9.7:1 in Night.
- **Warm text accent** = `ink-accent` for eyebrows and small emphasis.
- **Status** colours always travel with an icon and a word — red vs. green is never the only signal.
- **Sand** is for marketing bands and the blog's CTA band — never a page or card background in Day.
- Follow the visitor's `prefers-color-scheme` by default, let them switch in the nav, and remember it in a cookie so the server renders the right theme with no flash.

Surfaces, ink and borders

TOKEN	DAY	NIGHT	USE
`surface-page`	`#f8fafa`	`#0b1f26`	Page background. Day is near-white with a faint lagoon cast; Night is deep lagoon.
`surface-card`	`#ffffff`	`#13303a`	Cards, modals, nav bar, inputs, dashboard panels.
`surface-sunken`	`#eef3f3`	`#08171c`	Wells, table header rows, dashboard sidebar, code blocks.
`surface-inverse`	`#0e3a45`	`#e8f1f0`	Tooltips, footer band, toast background.
`surface-sand`	`#f5e8d3`	`#2a271d`	Warm beach band for blog CTA bands and newsletter panels. ink (10.2:1 Day, 13:1 Night), ink-muted and ink-accent all pass on it.
`ink`	`#0e3a45`	`#e8f1f0`	Headings and body text on surface-page, surface-card, surface-sunken (≥9.4:1 Day, ≥12:1 Night).
`ink-muted`	`#4a5b60`	`#9fb3b6`	Secondary text, hints, captions, placeholders on surface-page, surface-card, surface-sunken (≥5.4:1 Day, ≥6.3:1 Night).
`ink-inverse`	`#f5e8d3`	`#0b1f26`	Text on surface-inverse and brand-deep bands.
`ink-accent`	`#9c3e16`	`#ff8f7a`	Warm accent text: eyebrows, 'New' labels, small emphasis on surface-page and surface-card (≥5.5:1 Day, ≥6.2:1 Night).
`ink-on-deep-muted`	`#b9d3cf`	`#b9d3cf`	Secondary text on brand-deep bands (featured post banner, footer): excerpts, meta (7.8:1). Titles on brand-deep use brand-sand (10.2:1).

TOKEN	DAY	NIGHT	USE
`border`	`#dce5e5`	`#24434d`	Decorative dividers and card outlines where shape is also shown by fill. Not for control boundaries.
`border-strong`	`#687a7e`	`#6f8e95`	Input, select, checkbox and toggle-track outlines; must hold 3:1 on surface-card and surface-page.
`scrim`	`#0e3a4599`	`#000000b3`	Modal and mobile-drawer backdrop.

Actions and states

TOKEN	DAY	NIGHT	USE
`action-primary`	`#ffb662`	`#ffb662`	Primary button fill. One per view: the main conversion (Book a call, Hire a VA).
`action-primary-hover`	`#ff9f45`	`#ffc47f`	Primary button hover.
`action-primary-active`	`#f28a2e`	`#ffd29c`	Primary button pressed.
`on-action-primary`	`#0e3a45`	`#0b1f26`	Label and icon on action-primary and its hover/active fills (≥4.9:1).
`action-secondary`	`#0f6e68`	`#7dd3c9`	Secondary button fill; links; selected states; checkbox and toggle 'on'.
`action-secondary-hover`	`#0b5a55`	`#9be0d7`	Secondary hover; link hover.
`on-action-secondary`	`#ffffff`	`#0b1f26`	Label and icon on action-secondary (6.1:1 Day, 9.7:1 Night).
`action-ocean`	`#1f6fa8`	`#8cc4f0`	Ocean button fill for supporting blog CTAs (Subscribe, Join the newsletter) so they never compete with the single sunrise primary.
`action-ocean-hover`	`#185a8a`	`#a9d3f4`	Ocean button hover.
`on-action-ocean`	`#ffffff`	`#0b1f26`	Label on action-ocean and its hover (5.4:1 Day, 9.1:1 Night).
`action-ghost-hover`	`#0f6e681a`	`#7dd3c91f`	Ghost button and nav-link hover wash.
`link`	`#0f6e68`	`#7dd3c9`	Inline links on surface-page and surface-card; underline always on body copy.
`focus-ring`	`#0f6e68`	`#ffb662`	2px solid outline at 2px offset on every focusable element (≥4.6:1 Day, ≥8:1 Night on all surfaces).
`disabled-fill`	`#e8eded`	`#1e3a44`	Disabled control fill. Disabled text is exempt from contrast but stays readable.
`disabled-ink`	`#7f8a87`	`#6b8288`	Disabled labels and icons on disabled-fill.

Status

TOKEN	DAY	NIGHT	USE
`status-success`	`#2f6b3e`	`#7fcb93`	Success text/icon on surface-card and status-success-bg. Always with a check icon and a word.
`status-success-bg`	`#eaf4ec`	`#173a2a`	Success banner and badge fill.
`status-warning`	`#8a5a00`	`#f2c14e`	Warning text/icon. Always with an alert icon and a word.
`status-warning-bg`	`#fff4e0`	`#3a2e12`	Warning banner and badge fill.
`status-danger`	`#b42318`	`#ff9c8f`	Error text, invalid input border, destructive buttons. Always with an icon and a word.
`status-danger-bg`	`#fdecea`	`#3d1e1c`	Error banner and badge fill.
`status-info`	`#0f6e68`	`#7dd3c9`	Info text/icon.
`status-info-bg`	`#e3f3f1`	`#123b3d`	Info banner and badge fill.

Blog category tones

TOKEN	DAY	NIGHT	USE
`tag-lagoon-bg`	`#e0f5f2`	`#123b3d`	Blog category tone 'lagoon' (calm topics — remote work, how-tos): tag chip, avatar and cover-sky fill.
`tag-lagoon-ink`	`#0b5a55`	`#7dd3c9`	Text, dot and selected-chip fill for tone 'lagoon'. ≥5.7:1 on tag-lagoon-bg and ≥6.7:1 against surface-card in both themes.
`tag-coral-bg`	`#ffe9e1`	`#3d241c`	Blog category tone 'coral' (people topics — client stories, team spotlights): tag chip, avatar and cover-sky fill.
`tag-coral-ink`	`#9c3e16`	`#ffab94`	Text, dot and selected-chip fill for tone 'coral'. ≥5.7:1 on tag-coral-bg and ≥6.7:1 against surface-card in both themes.
`tag-sand-bg`	`#f5e8d3`	`#33291b`	Blog category tone 'sand' (culture topics — agency life, behind the scenes): tag chip, avatar and cover-sky fill.
`tag-sand-ink`	`#6b4a1f`	`#f0d9b5`	Text, dot and selected-chip fill for tone 'sand'. ≥5.7:1 on tag-sand-bg and ≥6.7:1 against surface-card in both themes.
`tag-ocean-bg`	`#e3eef8`	`#13304a`	Blog category tone 'ocean' (work topics — productivity, tools, guides): tag chip, avatar and cover-sky fill.
`tag-ocean-ink`	`#1a5a8c`	`#8cc4f0`	Text, dot and selected-chip fill for tone 'ocean'. ≥5.7:1 on tag-ocean-bg and ≥6.7:1 against surface-card in both themes.

Charts

TOKEN	DAY	NIGHT	USE
`chart-1`	`#0a9088`	`#1ca79e`	Chart series 1 (teal). Assign in order 1→6, never cycled; a 7th series folds into 'Other'. Validated: adjacent CVD ΔE ≥13 Day / ≥14.6 Night, ≥3:1 on surface-card. Marks only — labels stay in ink tokens.
`chart-2`	`#d36b12`	`#da721e`	Chart series 2 (orange). Assign in order 1→6, never cycled; a 7th series folds into 'Other'. Validated: adjacent CVD ΔE ≥13 Day / ≥14.6 Night, ≥3:1 on surface-card. Marks only — labels stay in ink tokens.
`chart-3`	`#1f6fa8`	`#418cc7`	Chart series 3 (ocean). Assign in order 1→6, never cycled; a 7th series folds into 'Other'. Validated: adjacent CVD ΔE ≥13 Day / ≥14.6 Night, ≥3:1 on surface-card. Marks only — labels stay in ink tokens.
`chart-4`	`#5f9a3c`	`#69a547`	Chart series 4 (green). Assign in order 1→6, never cycled; a 7th series folds into 'Other'. Validated: adjacent CVD ΔE ≥13 Day / ≥14.6 Night, ≥3:1 on surface-card. Marks only — labels stay in ink tokens.
`chart-5`	`#9a7be0`	`#9576db`	Chart series 5 (violet). Assign in order 1→6, never cycled; a 7th series folds into 'Other'. Validated: adjacent CVD ΔE ≥13 Day / ≥14.6 Night, ≥3:1 on surface-card. Marks only — labels stay in ink tokens.
`chart-6`	`#b8436a`	`#cf587d`	Chart series 6 (rose). Assign in order 1→6, never cycled; a 7th series folds into 'Other'. Validated: adjacent CVD ΔE ≥13 Day / ≥14.6 Night, ≥3:1 on surface-card. Marks only — labels stay in ink tokens.
`chart-grid`	`#e6ecec`	`#1f3d47`	Gridlines and baseline ticks inside charts; recessive by design.
`chart-other`	`#7d8a8d`	`#6f8e95`	The folded 'Other' series and inactive/filtered-out marks (3.6:1 Day, 4:1 Night on surface-card).

Every text pair in these tables is checked to WCAG 2.1 AA (4.5:1) in both themes; the chart order is validated for colour-blind readers. See *Data visualization*.

FOUNDATIONS

Typography

Two families with distinct jobs: **Alegreya**, the serif of the wordmark, for headlines; **Figtree**, a friendly geometric sans, for everything people read and click.

Aa

Alegreya

Display serif, 700/800. `display-xl` → `h2` only. Gives the brand its humane, hand-touched warmth.

Aa

Figtree

Sans, 400–700. All interface text from `h3` down. Wide x-height, legible at 14–16px.

Aa

JetBrains Mono

Only for invoice and ticket IDs, API keys and code samples.

SAMPLE	STYLE	USE
Support, day and night	`display-xl` Alegreya 800 56px / 60px	Hero headline only. Fluid: clamp(2.5rem, 1.6rem + 3.6vw, 3.5rem).
Your business, always on	`display-lg` Alegreya 700 44px / 50px	Section openers on marketing pages. Fluid: clamp(2rem, 1.5rem + 2vw, 2.75rem).
Choose your plan	`h1` Alegreya 700 36px / 42px	Page title, one per page. Fluid: clamp(1.875rem, 1.6rem + 1.1vw, 2.25rem).
Executive assistance	`h2` Alegreya 700 28px / 34px	Section headings, modal titles.
Inbox & calendar	`h3` Figtree 600 22px / 28px	Card titles, dashboard panel titles.
This week	`h4` Figtree 600 18px / 24px	Sub-sections, form-group legends.
A dedicated assistant who knows your business.	`body-lg` Figtree 400 18px / 28px	Lead paragraphs, hero sub-copy. Max 60ch.
We cover inbox, scheduling and customer replies around the clock.	`body` Figtree 400 16px / 24px	Default text. Never below 16px for long-form or input values (prevents iOS zoom).
Billed monthly. Cancel anytime.	`body-sm` Figtree 400 14px / 20px	Secondary detail, table cells, helper text.
Work email	`label` Figtree 600 14px / 20px	Form labels, button labels (sm/md), tabs, nav links.
Updated 2 min ago	`caption` Figtree 500 12px / 16px	Timestamps, badges, chart axis labels. Never for essential instructions.
SUPPORT, DAY AND NIGHT	`eyebrow` Figtree 700 12px / 16px	Uppercase kicker above headings — echoes the logo tagline. Set text-transform: uppercase in CSS; write the source text in sentence case for screen readers.
`INV-2026-0412`	`code` JetBrains Mono 400 14px / 20px	Invoice and ticket IDs, API keys (masked), code samples.

- Body is `body` 16/24; lead paragraphs `body-lg` 18/28; line length 45–75 characters (`container-prose`). Use `rem` in production CSS so browser zoom works.
- One `h1` per page. Pick the heading level for structure, then apply the style — never skip levels for size.
- Minimum text size 12px (`caption`), only for non-essential metadata. Inputs never below 16px. In Next.js load the fonts with `next/font/google` .

FOUNDATIONS

Spacing, shape & motion

A 4px base, soft radii echoing the logo's arcs, quiet elevation and calm motion.

Spacing scale

TOKEN	VALUE	TYPICAL USE
`space-1`	4px	Icon-to-label gap inside badges; tight inline gaps.
`space-2`	8px	Button icon gap; label-to-input gap; chip padding.
`space-3`	12px	Input horizontal padding; list-item gap.
`space-4`	16px	Mobile page gutter; card padding (compact); grid gap (mobile).
`space-5`	20px	Field-to-field vertical rhythm in forms.
`space-6`	24px	Card padding; desktop grid gap; tablet gutter.
`space-8`	32px	Modal padding (desktop); gap between card groups; desktop gutter.
`space-10`	40px	Heading-to-content gap in sections.
`space-12`	48px	Section padding (mobile).
`space-16`	64px	Section padding (tablet).
`space-24`	96px	Section padding (desktop marketing).

Use the scale only — no in-between values. Card padding `space-6`; form rhythm `space-5`; sections `space-12` → `space-16` → `space-24` from mobile to desktop.

Radius



`radius-sm`
6px
Checkboxes, badges, tooltips.

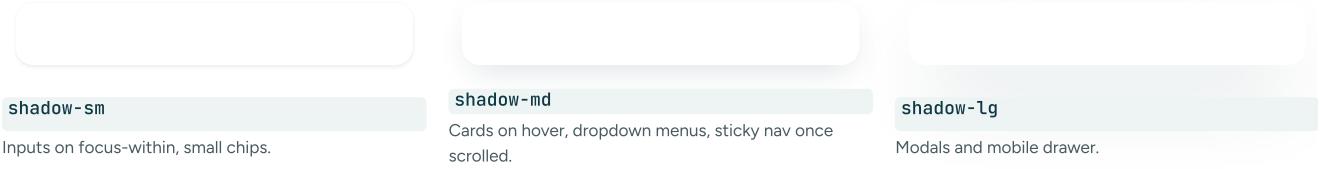
`radius-md`
10px
Buttons, inputs, selects, nav links.

`radius-lg`
16px
Cards, dashboard panels, dropdown menus.

`radius-xl`
24px
Modals, hero media, feature panels.

`radius-pill`
999px
Toggles, avatar frames, pill filters, status dots.

Elevation



`shadow-sm`

Inputs on focus-within, small chips.

`shadow-md`

Cards on hover, dropdown menus, sticky nav once scrolled.

`shadow-lg`

Modals and mobile drawer.

Borders first; shadows (tinted with brand-deep, never black in Day) only for things that float — menus, hovered cards, modals.

Motion

- Calm and short: 120–200ms, `ease` or `cubic-bezier(.2,.8,.2,1)` for entrances.
- Nothing bounces; nothing loops except loading spinners and skeleton shimmer.
- The blog's wave sweeps and the hero's drifting waves run longer (600–900ms) — a single eased movement on hover, never a loop.
- Theme change crossfades colours over 200ms. Everything respects `prefers-reduced-motion`.

States

Hover	A tint step or `action-ghost-hover` wash
Active	Next tint step + 1px press
Focus	2px solid `focus-ring` at 2px offset — every focusable element, every theme
Disabled	`disabled-fill` + `disabled-ink`
Loading	Spinner + `aria-busy`, control disabled
Error	`status-danger` border + icon + message

FOUNDATIONS

Layout & grid

Design mobile-first at **360px**, then add layout as space appears. Breakpoints are min-width and match the `bp-*` tokens.

TOKEN	MIN WIDTH	COLUMNS	GUTTER (PAGE EDGE)	GAP	TYPICAL CHANGE
—	0	4	16px (`space-4`)	16px	Single column, stacked cards, bottom-sheet modals
`bp-sm`	640px	4	24px (`space-6`)	16px	2-up cards, nav shows CTA, modals centre
`bp-md`	768px	8	32px (`space-8`)	24px	Nav shows 3 links, dashboard icon rail
`bp-lg`	1024px	12	32px	24px	Full nav, full sidebar, 3-up cards
`bp-xl`	1280px	12	auto (centred)	24px	Content caps at `container-max` 1200px

Containers

- Marketing sections: `max-width: var(--container-max); margin-inline: auto; padding-inline: <gutter>`.
- Long-form text: `max-width: var(--container-prose)` (68ch).
- Full-bleed bands (hero, testimonials, footer) span edge to edge; their content snaps back to the container.
- Dashboard: no max width — the 12-column grid fills the space beside the sidebar, because operators use wide screens.

Component-level responsiveness

Prefer **container queries** for components (NavBar, DashboardShell and Grid use `container-type: inline-size`) so a component adapts to the slot it is placed in; use media queries only for page-level layout and for things tied to the viewport (modals, drawers).

Vertical rhythm

BETWEEN	SPACE
Form fields	`space-5`
Heading and its content	`space-4` (`h3` / `h4`), `space-10` (section `h2`)
Cards in a grid	`space-6`
Page sections	`space-12` mobile · `space-16` tablet · `space-24` desktop

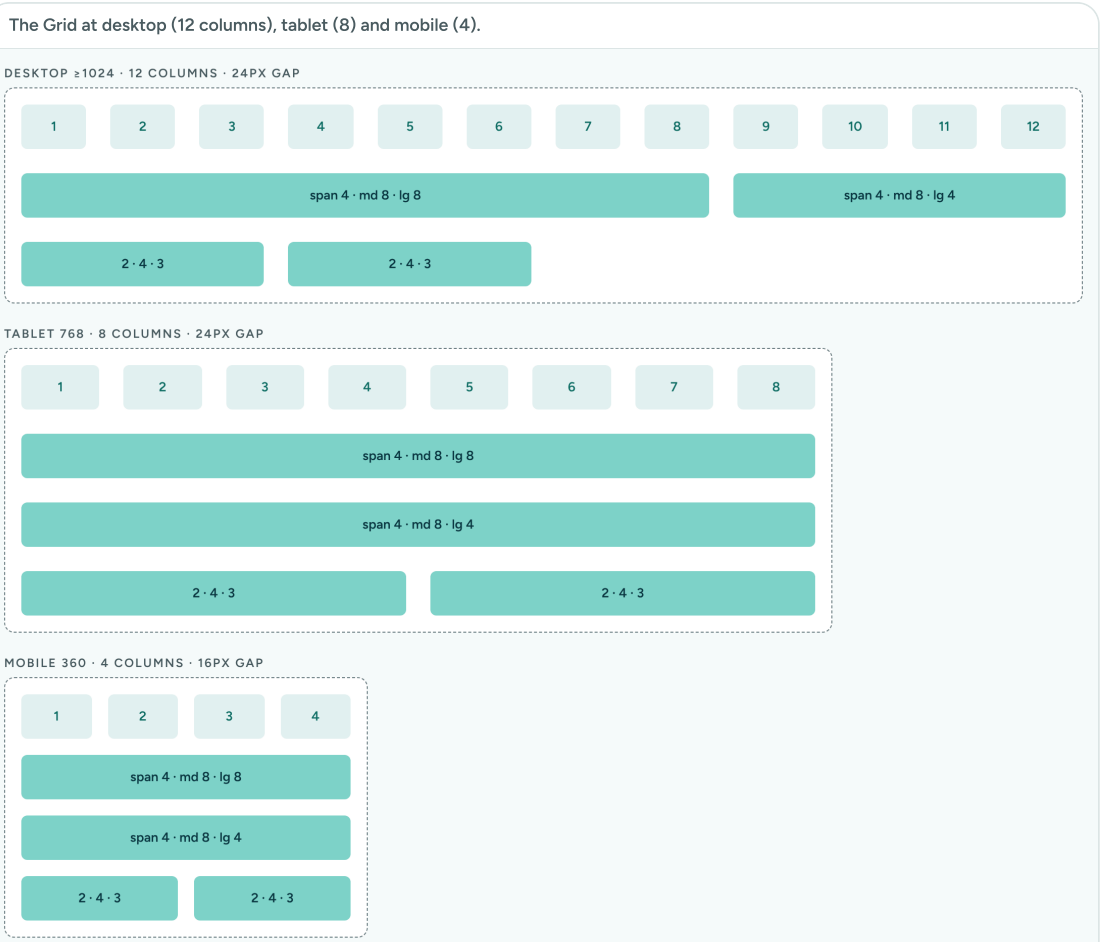
Fluid type

Display styles scale with `clamp()` between 360 and 1280px (formula in each style's note). Body and UI text never scale with the viewport; users' browser zoom and font-size settings must work (use `rem` in production CSS — 16px = 1rem).

Touch and pointer

Every interactive target is at least `tap-target` (44×44px), with at least `space-2` between adjacent targets. Hover-only affordances are never the only way to reach an action.

The Grid at desktop (12 columns), tablet (8) and mobile (4).



FOUNDATIONS

Logo use

Always use the supplied files from the Logos group in the live system. Never redraw, recolour (other than the supplied night version), stretch or add effects.



Day lockup · `islandsva-lockup.png`



Night lockup · `islandsva-lockup-night.png`



Mark · `islandsva-mark.png`



Night mark · `islandsva-mark-night.png`

Where each goes

- Horizontal lockup in the nav (40px tall) and footer
- Mark alone for the favicon, app icon, dashboard sidebar and avatars
- Day files on `surface-page` / `surface-card`; night files on Night surfaces and `brand-deep` bands (the footer, the featured blog banner)

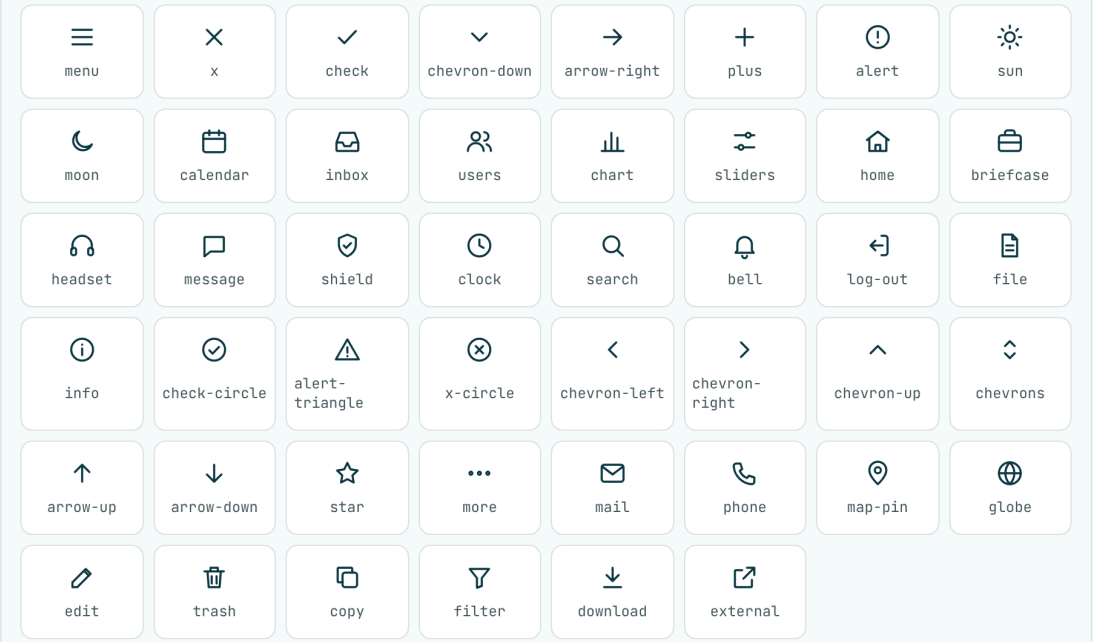
Spacing and size

- Clear space = the height of the sun dot on every side
- Minimum size: lockup 32px tall, mark 24px
- The transparent and night files were cut from the supplied PNG — replace them with exports from the original vector artwork (SVG) when available

FOUNDATIONS

Iconography & imagery

The built-in outline icon set (46 icons) — 24px grid, 1.75px rounded stroke.



Icons

- **Style:** outline, 24px grid, 2px live-area padding, **1.75px stroke**, round caps and joins — the same soft line as the logo's arcs. No filled icons, no duotone, no emoji as icons.
- **Source:** the built-in `Icon` set (46 icons) covers navigation and core actions. Extend with **Lucide** (`lucide-react`) at `strokeWidth={1.75}`; import icons one by one (`import { CalendarClock } from "lucide-react"`) so only what is used ships.
- **Sizes:** 16 (inline, pills), 20 (buttons, nav, inputs), 24 (cards, panels), 32–48 (empty states, inside a `radius-pill` tinted disc like ServiceCard's).
- **Colour:** inherit `currentColor`. Feature icons sit in a `status-info-bg` disc in `action-secondary`. Never orange icons on light grounds.
- **Meaning:** an icon alone needs an accessible name (`label` / `aria-label`); with visible text it is decorative (`aria-hidden`). Keep one icon per concept across the product (inbox = `inbox`, always).
- **Day/night motif:** `sun` and `moon` are reserved for the theme switch and for day/night shift indicators — don't reuse them as decoration.

Photography

- Real people, real work: assistants and clients at desks, on calls, reviewing a calendar — candid, not posed handshakes or headset stock.
- Warm, natural light; colour-graded slightly toward sand and lagoon. Day scenes for the "day" story, softly lit evening scenes (lamps, city at dusk) for the "night" story — the pair tells *continuous support*.
- Tropical cues are subtle (plants, natural textures, a window view) — no beach-vacation clichés, cocktails or hammocks; the brand is calm, not on holiday.
- Diverse and representative of the actual team and clients. Get model releases; never use photos of real team members without consent.
- Crop to `radius-xl` corners for hero/feature media; no drop shadows, no hard frames.

Illustration

- Built from the logo's shapes: arcs (open circles), the sun dot, the moon crescent, palm fronds, a horizon line. Flat fills in brand hues, no gradients, no outlines thicker than 2px.

- Use for empty states, onboarding and error pages ("Nothing waiting on you — your VA has it covered." with the moon over a calm horizon).
- Keep illustration as SVG, inline when it needs theme colours (fills via `var(--brand-*)` so it adapts to Night).

Image delivery (Next.js)

- Always `next/image`: explicit `width`/`height` or `fill` + `sizes` to avoid layout shift; AVIF/WebP served automatically.
- The single LCP image per page (hero) gets `priority` (or `preload`) and `fetchPriority="high"`; everything else lazy-loads by default.
- Set `sizes` honestly (`"(min-width: 1024px) 50vw, 100vw"`) so phones don't download desktop images.
- `placeholder="blur"` with static imports for hero/testimonial photos.
- Alt text describes what matters in context ("Maria, a night-shift VA, replying to a client chat"); decorative images get `alt=""`. Logos use the company name.
- Remote images only from allow-listed hosts in `images.remotePatterns`.

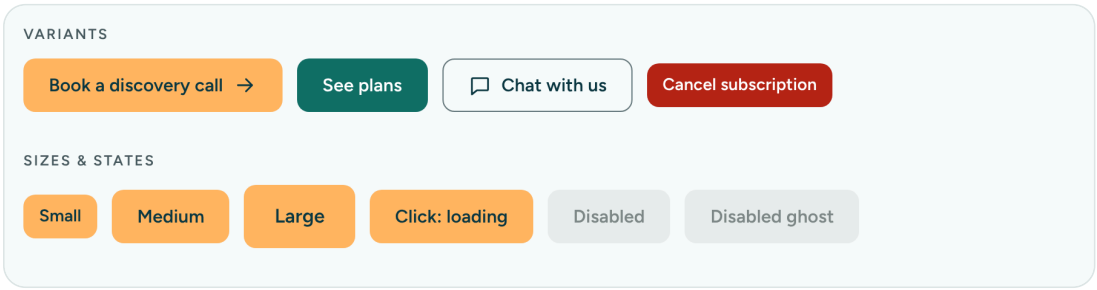
COMPONENTS

Actions & forms

Buttons, inputs and the dialog that holds them.

Button

Triggers an action, or navigates when given an href, in five emphasis levels.



USING IT

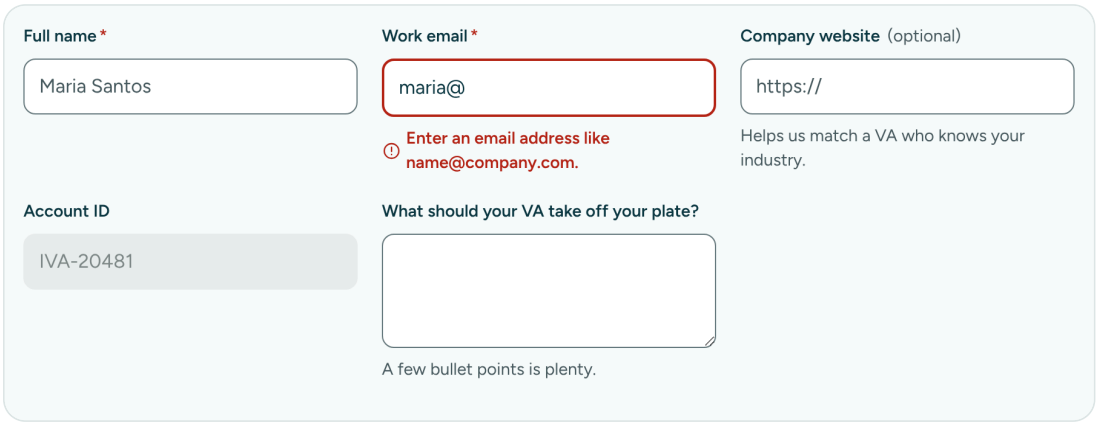
- **primary** (sunrise): the single main conversion per view — Book a call, Hire a VA
- **secondary** (teal): supporting actions; **ghost**: low emphasis
- **danger**: destructive confirmations inside a modal only
- **ocean**: supporting CTAs like Subscribe when a sunrise primary is already on screen
- Sizes sm 36px · md 44px · lg 52px; `loading` shows a spinner and blocks double-submit

RULES

- Labels are verb-first and specific: *Request my team*, never *Submit* or *Learn more*
- One primary per view. If two buttons feel equally important, one of them isn't
- Use `href` for navigation, buttons for actions — never the other way round

TextField

A labelled single- or multi-line input with hint and error wired to assistive tech.



USING IT

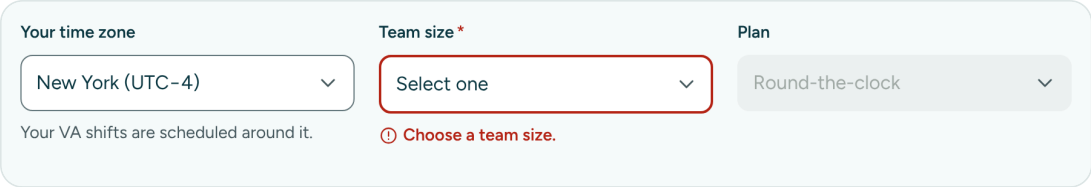
- Always a visible `label` — placeholders never replace labels
- Always set `autoComplete` (name, email, tel, one-time-code…)
- Optional `hint`, `error`, `required` / `optional`, `multiline`

RULES

- Errors: 2px `status-danger` border + icon + text that says how to fix it
- Validate on blur and submit, not every keystroke; move focus to the first invalid field
- Client validation is a courtesy — the server action re-validates with the same Zod schema
- 16px text and 44px height so iOS never zooms on focus

Select

A styled native select: free keyboard support, screen-reader semantics and the phone's own picker.



USING IT

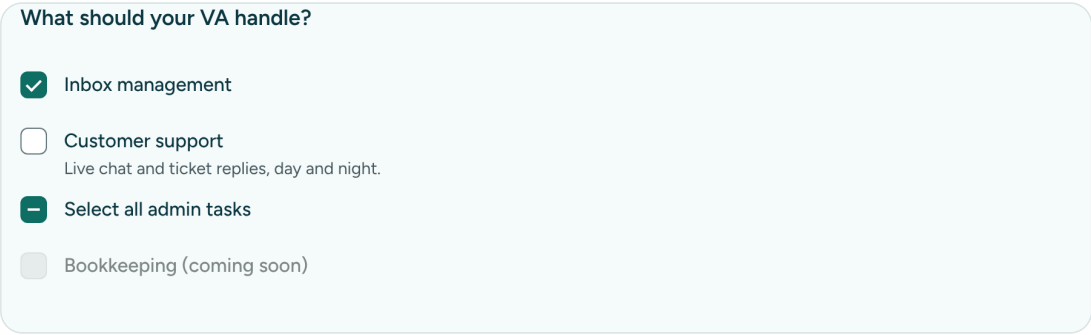
- 2–15 options. Fewer than 4 → radio buttons; more than 15 → a searchable combobox
- Same label, hint and error wiring as TextField

RULES

- Sort options logically (by size, by time-zone offset), not alphabetically by default
- Build custom listboxes only on a tested primitive (Radix Select / React Aria), skinned with these tokens

Checkbox

A native checkbox with label and optional description, for multi-select choices and consent.



USING IT

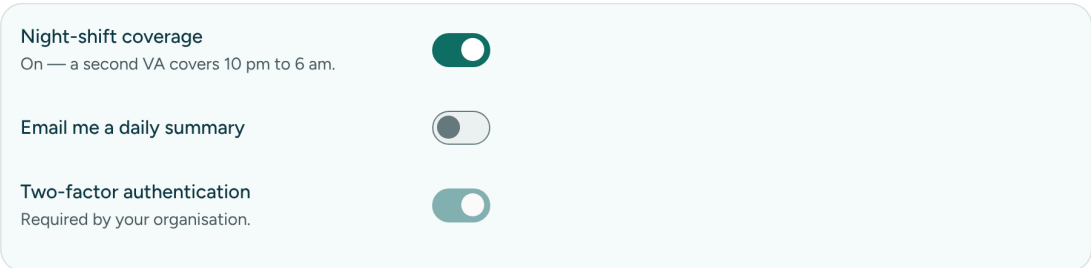
- Group related boxes in a `fieldset` with a `legend`
- `indeterminate` for "select all" parents

RULES

- Consent boxes are never pre-checked; marketing consent is separate from terms
- Use a Toggle when the change applies immediately; checkboxes are submitted with a form

Toggle

An on/off switch (`role="switch"`) for settings that take effect immediately.



USING IT

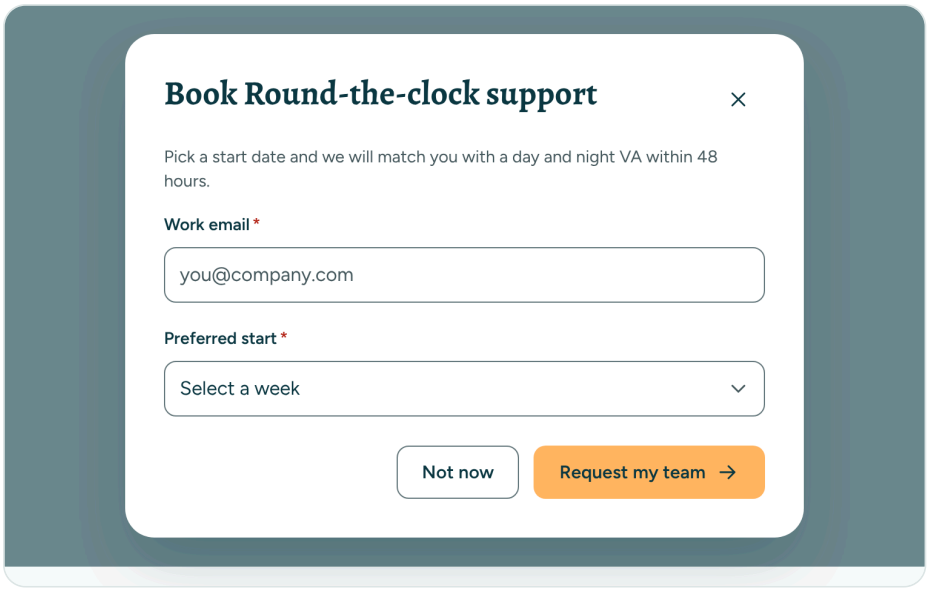
- Label states the setting ("Night-shift coverage"), not the action
- Save on toggle with optimistic UI and a rollback toast on failure

RULES

- Off state keeps a `border-strong` outline so it's perceivable (≥3:1)
- Space and Enter toggle; the label is clickable

Modal

A focused dialog for details, bookings and confirmations that traps focus and restores it on close.



USING IT

- Footer buttons: secondary first, primary last (they reverse-stack on phones)
- Phones: bottom sheet, max 90dvh. ≥640px: centred, max 560px
- `role="alertdialog"` + `dismissible={false}` for destructive confirmations

RULES

- One task per modal; long forms belong on a page
- Never open on page load or stack modals
- For shareable states use an intercepting route so the URL and back button work

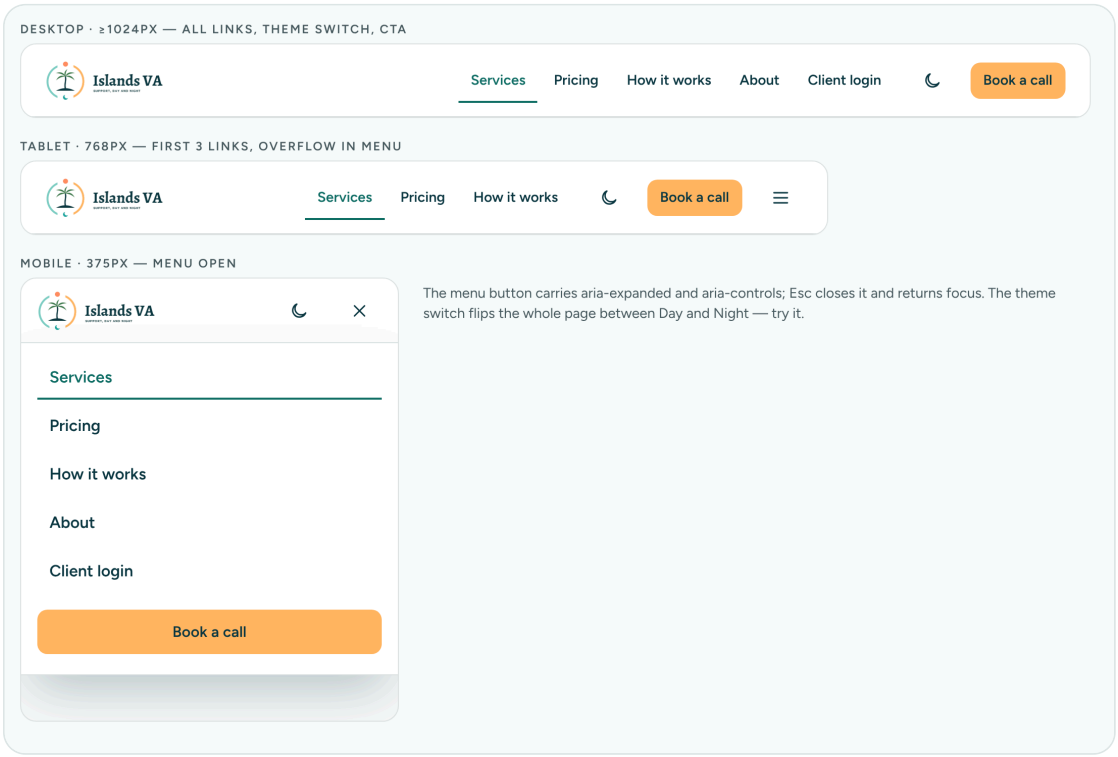
COMPONENTS

Navigation

Getting around the marketing site and the client app.

NavBar

The global top bar — logo, links, day/night switch, one CTA and a mobile menu — adapting to its own width.



USING IT

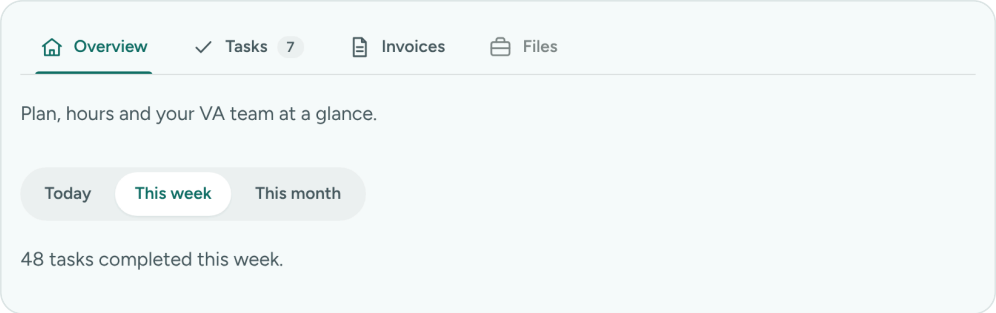
- < 640px: logo + menu; 640px adds the CTA; 768px shows 3 links; ≥1024px everything inline
- `logo.day` / `logo.night` are the lockups from the Logos group

RULES

- Sticky, with `shadow-md` only after scroll; a Skip-to-content link comes first
- Never hide the theme switch on desktop — day and night is the brand promise
- The drawer closes on Esc, route change and link click

Tabs

Switch between views of the same thing without leaving the page.



USING IT

- 2–6 tabs with one- or two-word labels; optional icon and count
- **underline** (default) or **pill** for compact filters inside panels

RULES

- Arrow keys move and activate, Home/End jump — one tab stop for the whole list
- If a tab needs its own URL, render links with `aria-current` and keep the look
- More than six destinations is navigation — use the sidebar

Breadcrumbs

Where a page sits in the hierarchy, with links back up.



USING IT

- Use on pages two or more levels deep; never as the only navigation

RULES

- Collapses to parent + current page below 640px
- Last item is the current page (`aria-current="page"`), not a link

Pagination

Previous / numbers / Next for long lists, with ellipses after seven pages.



USING IT

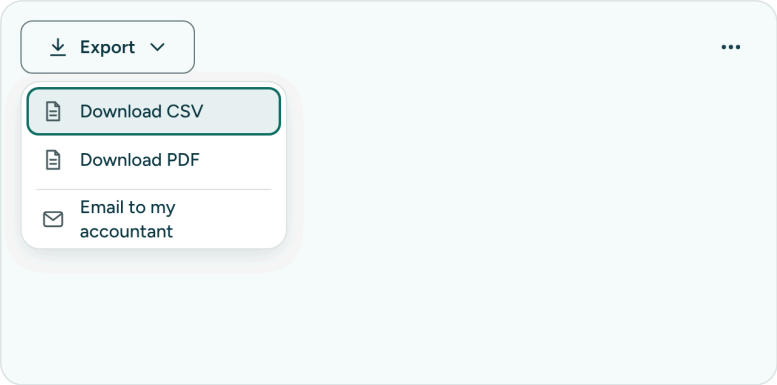
- Prefer real links via `hrefFor` (`?page=3`) so back button and search engines work

RULES

- Collapses to “Page 3 of 12” between Previous and Next on phones
- 44px targets; the current page is a teal fill

DropdownMenu

A button that opens a short list of actions — row actions, export, account.



USING IT

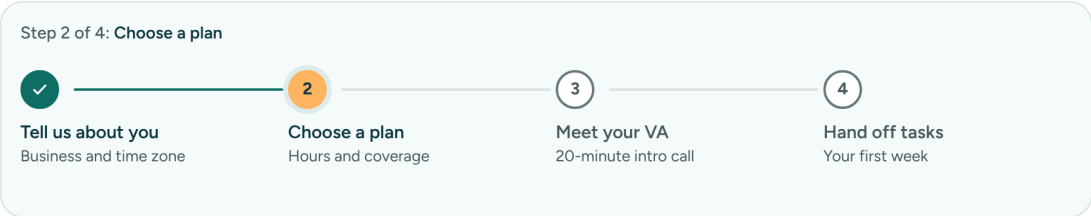
- Items: label, icon, hint, `danger`, `disabled`, separators
- `iconOnly` + `align="end"` for “more” buttons at the right edge

RULES

- Actions only — Select for values, links for navigation
- Destructive items go last, after a separator, and confirm in a Modal
- ↑/↓ move, Esc closes and returns focus, clicking outside closes

Stepper

Progress through a short flow — onboarding, hiring a VA, setting up a plan.



USING IT

- 3–6 steps; completed steps can link back
- Vertical below 720px of container width, horizontal above

RULES

- Each step is one screen; save progress so people can leave and return
- A text summary (“Step 2 of 4: Choose a plan”) leads for screen readers

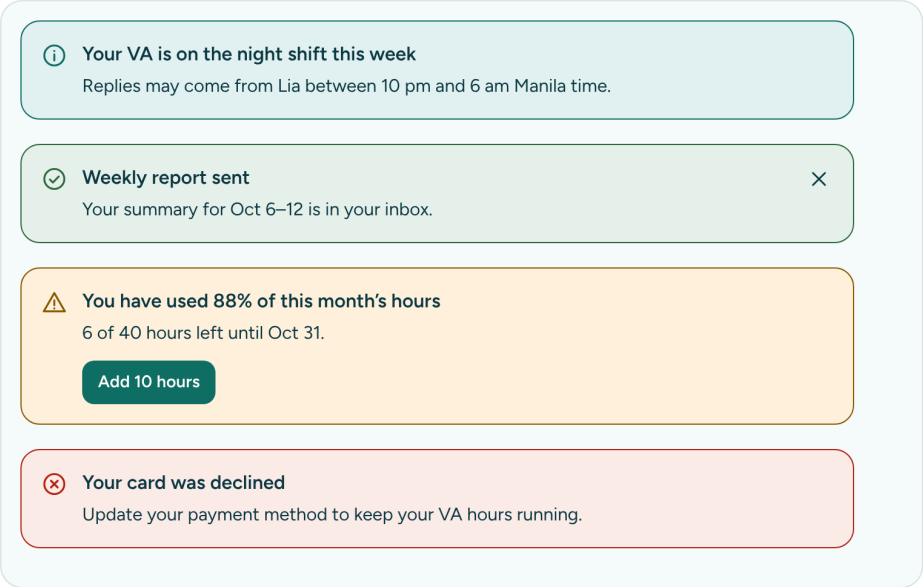
COMPONENTS

Feedback & status

Telling people what happened — calmly and in plain words.

Alert

An inline message that stays in the page until it's resolved: info, success, warning, danger.



USING IT

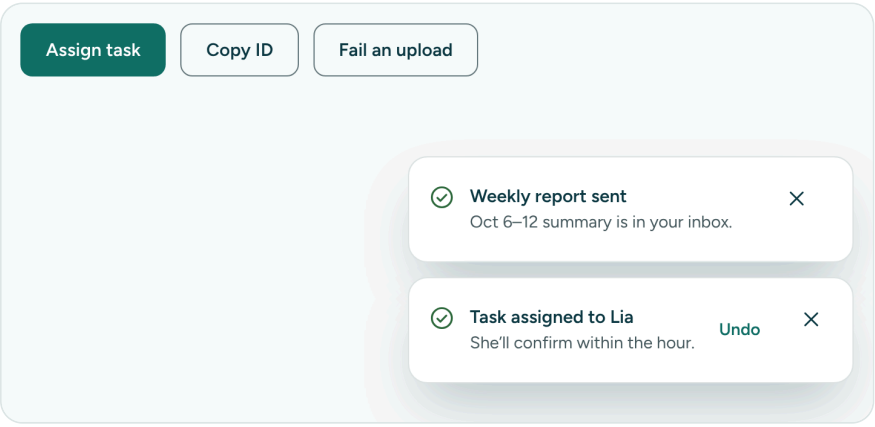
- Title says what happened; body says what to do; optional small action Button
- Warning and danger are announced immediately; info and success politely

RULES

- Icon + title + tint + outline always together — colour is never the only signal
- "Your card expires on Oct 31. Update it to keep your VA hours running." — not "Payment error!"

Toast

A brief confirmation, bottom-right (full width on phones), after the user does something.



USING IT

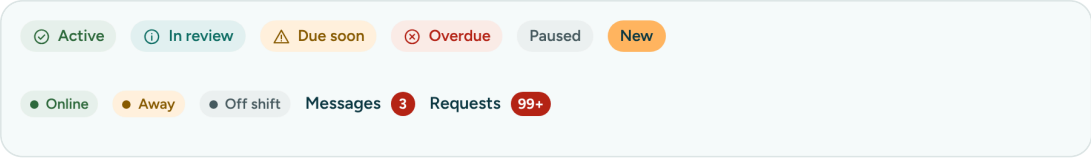
- Wrap the app once in `ToastProvider`; call `useToast().show({...})`
- Default 6s; `duration: 0` keeps it until dismissed; max three stack

RULES

- Only for outcomes of the user's own action — system problems are an Alert
- One optional follow-up action ("Undo"); never steals focus

Badge

A small rounded label for status or category; CountBadge for unread counts.



USING IT

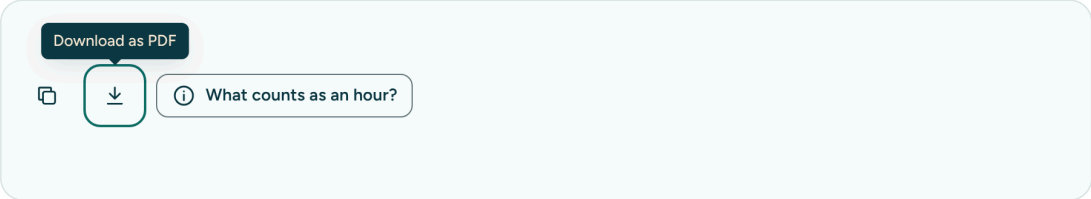
- Tones: neutral, info, success, warning, danger, brand
- `dot` and `size="sm"` for tables and task rows

RULES

- The word carries the meaning; colour reinforces it
- **brand** (sunrise) is for marketing highlights like “New”, never for status
- Badges aren't buttons — use a TagChip link to filter

Tooltip

A short dark label for icon buttons and metrics, on hover and keyboard focus.



USING IT

- Plain text under ~80 characters around one focusable child

RULES

- Supplements the control's own name — icon buttons still need `aria-label`
- No links, buttons or essential instructions inside — touch users may never see it

Skeleton

Soft placeholders that hold the layout while data loads.

USING IT

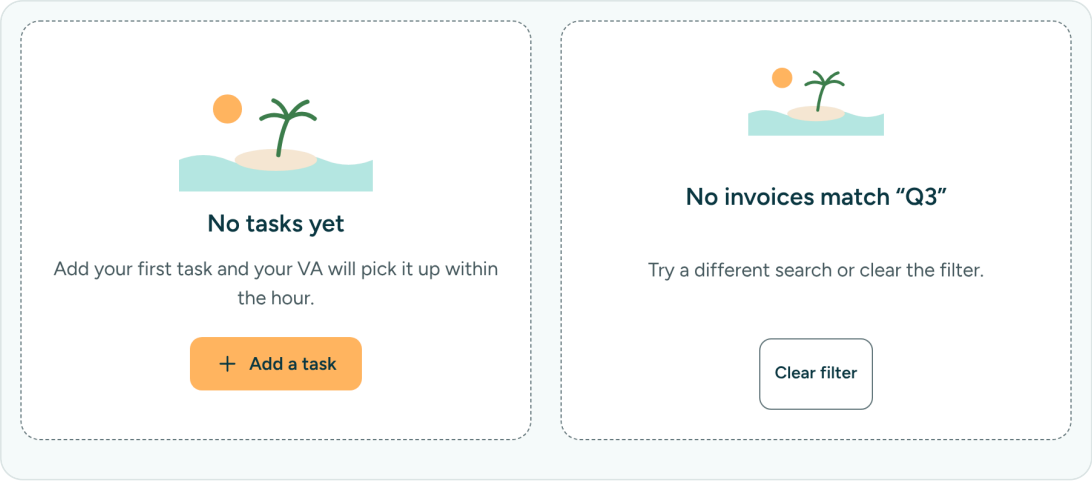
- text, rect and circle shapes; SkeletonCard composes them
- In Next.js: `loading.tsx` or a `<Suspense>` fallback

RULES

- Match the real layout; show only after ~300ms to avoid a flash
- The shimmer stops under reduced motion

EmptyState

What a list or panel shows when there's nothing in it yet — with the action that fills it.



USING IT

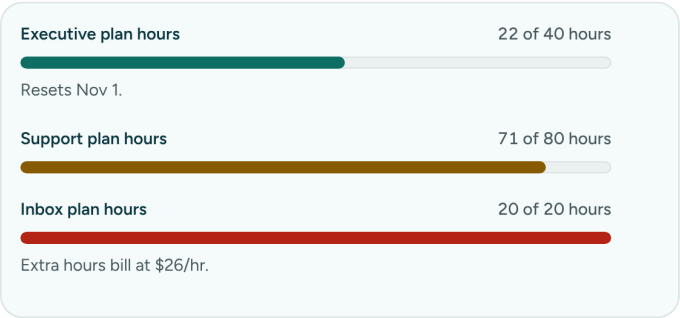
- First use: “No tasks yet — add your first and your VA will pick it up”
- No results: “No invoices match ‘Q3’ — clear the filter”
- All done: “Inbox zero. Nothing needs you right now”

RULES

- One primary action at most; never blame, never “Oops”

ProgressBar

Usage against a limit — plan hours, onboarding, uploads.



USING IT

- `valueText` (“34 of 40 hours”) is always shown

RULES

- Turns warning at 85% and danger at 100%; the number in words means colour is never the only signal

COMPONENTS

Dashboard & data

The signed-in client portal: numbers, records and people.

DashboardShell

The portal frame: sidebar of sections, sticky top bar with title and actions, and the content grid.



USING IT

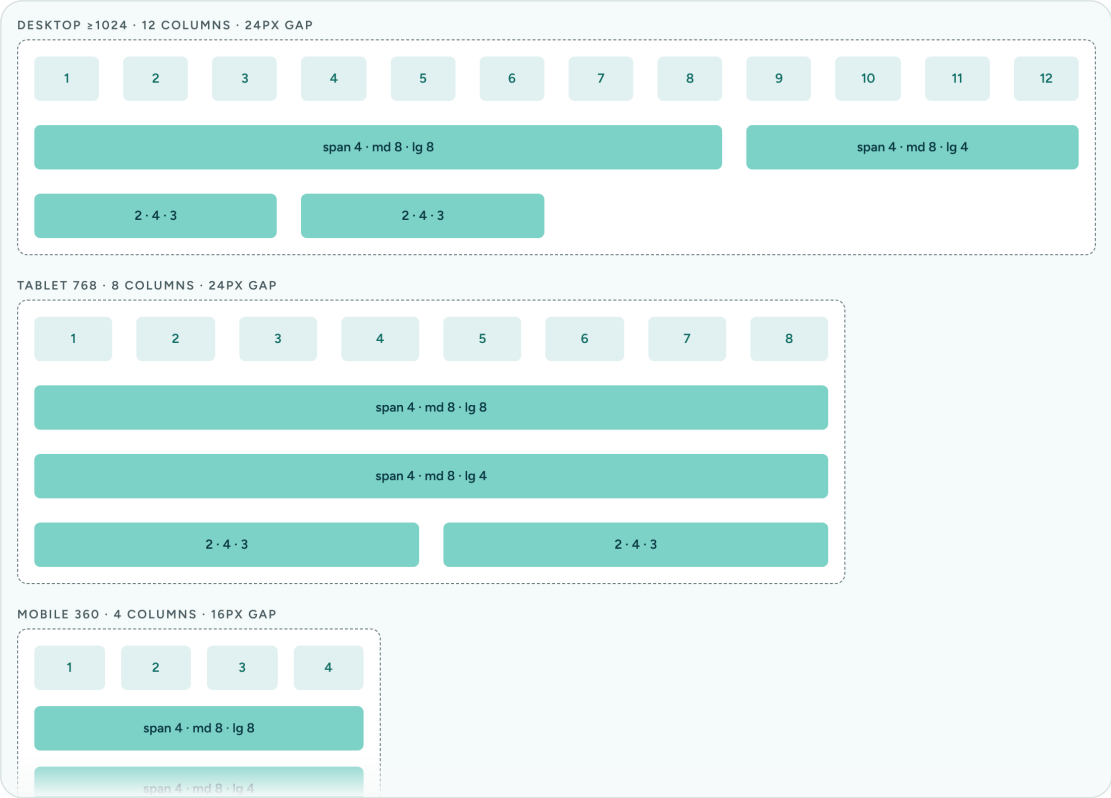
- < 768px: drawer; 768–1023px: 76px icon rail; ≥1024px: 264px sidebar with labels
- Lives in `app/(dashboard)/layout.tsx` so it persists across navigations

RULES

- Gate the route group in the proxy **and** re-check the session in every page and action
- Wrap each panel in its own `<Suspense>` so slow widgets stream in

Grid

The fluid 4 / 8 / 12-column grid, sized by its container rather than the viewport.



USING IT

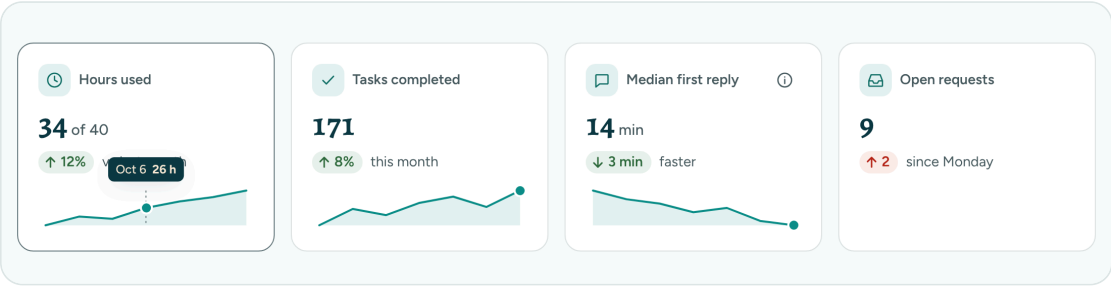
- KPI tile 2·4·3 · main + side 8/4 · two panels 6/6 · full table 12

RULES

- Gaps come from the grid — never margins on items
- Reading order follows source order at every breakpoint

StatCard

One headline number with its change and an optional sparkline (hover shown).



USING IT

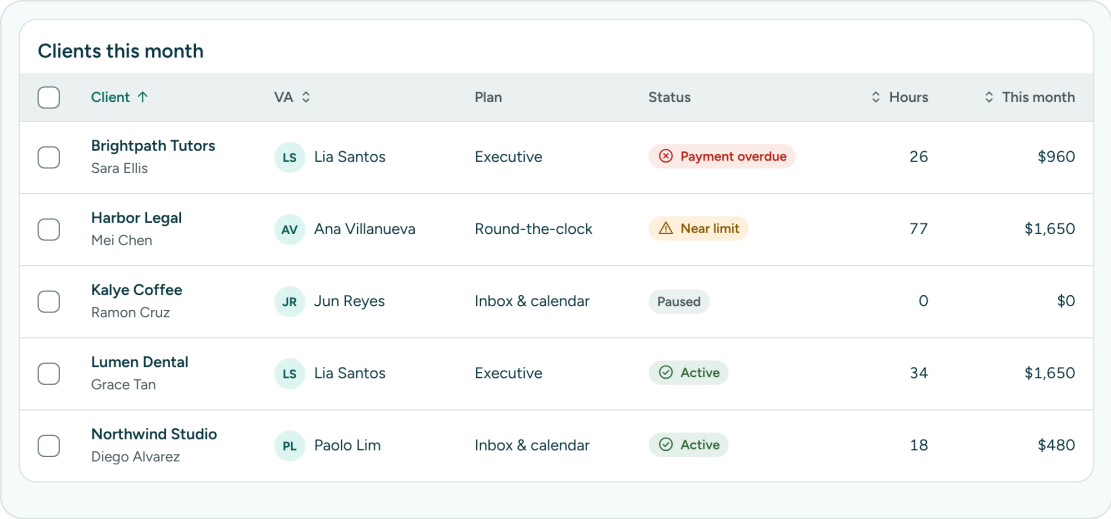
- `delta.good` for when down is good — faster reply time is down *and* good
- Place 2–4 in a row: `span 4 · md 4 · lg 3`

RULES

- One number per card, Alegreya 32px, tabular figures
- Deltas show arrow + number + tint; screen readers hear “improved” or “worse”
- Sparklines show shape, not values — link to a full chart for detail

DataTable

Sortable, optionally selectable records that become cards on phones.



USING IT

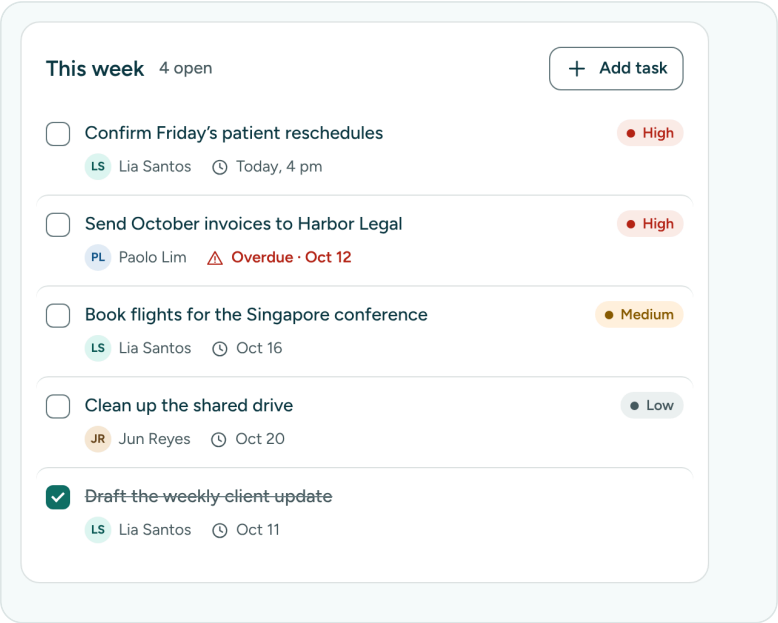
- Always a `caption`; first column is the row header
- Selection shows a dark bulk bar with count and actions
- Status → Badge · people → Avatar + name · row actions → icon DropdownMenu

RULES

- 3–7 columns; numbers right-aligned in tabular figures
- Hundreds of rows: paginate server-side and keep sort in the URL

TaskList

The shared to-do panel: tick tasks off, see who has them and when they're due.



USING IT

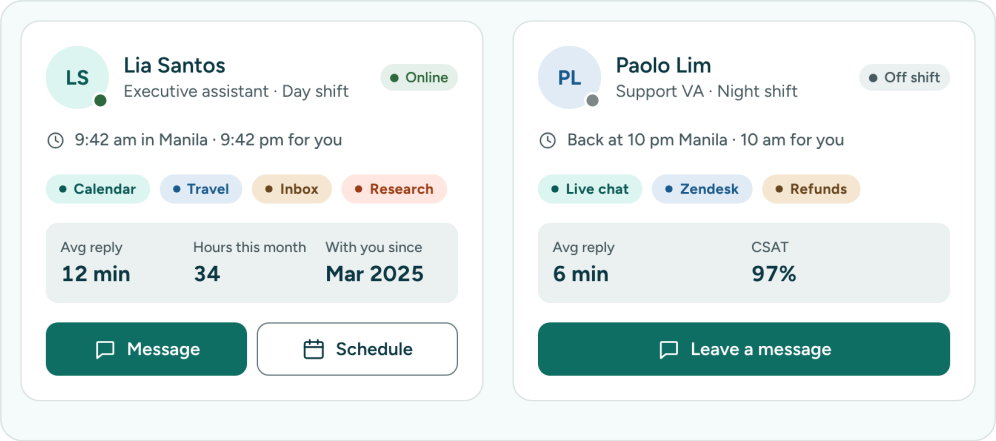
- `onToggle(id, done)` persists through a Server Action

RULES

- Titles start with a verb and name the outcome
- Overdue = red + alert icon + the word "Overdue"; open before done, then by due date

ProfileCard

Introduces a VA: shift status, both time zones, skills, stats and how to reach them.



USING IT

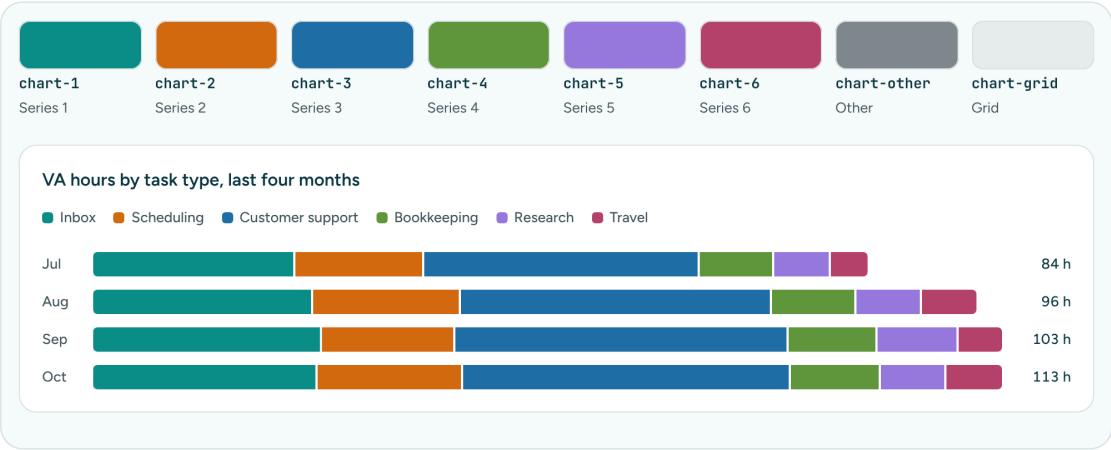
- status: online · away · offline (“Off shift”)
- `localTime` shows both zones: “9:42 am in Manila · 9:42 pm for you”

RULES

- Presence is a dot **and** a labelled badge, never the dot alone
- Keep stats factual and recent

Chart colours

The validated categorical order for charts, with legend and per-mark hover.



USING IT

- Assign `chart-1` → `chart-6` in order; a seventh series folds into “Other”
- Single-series charts use `chart-1` only

RULES

- See *Data visualization* for the full rules

COMPONENTS

Marketing

The public site: promise, proof and plans.

Hero

The opening section: eyebrow, the one big promise, lead, CTAs, proof line and the day-and-night art.

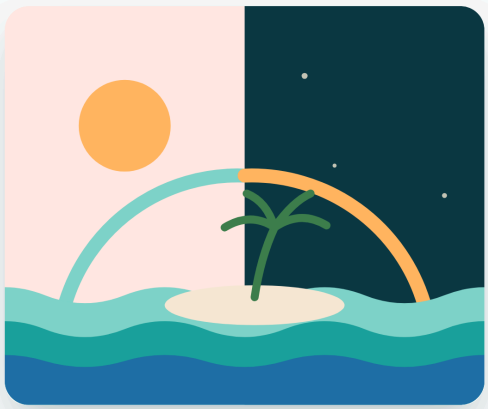
SUPPORT, DAY AND NIGHT

Your business, handled around the clock

A dedicated virtual assistant team in the Philippines that covers your inbox, calendar and customers while you sleep — and hands everything back by morning.

Book a discovery call → | See how it works

Trusted by 120+ small businesses · Same-hour response target



USING IT

- Title under ~10 words; lead outcome-first; `primary` is the page's single sunrise button
- `media` swaps the illustration for a photo of real people at work

RULES

- One hero and one `h1` per page; never text over the art
- On hover the waves drift and sun and moon ease apart; still under reduced motion

LogoStrip

A quiet row of client logos — greyscale, full colour on hover.

Trusted by teams at

Lumen Dental | Northwind | HARBOR LEGAL | Kalye Coffee | Brightpath | TIDEWATER

USING IT

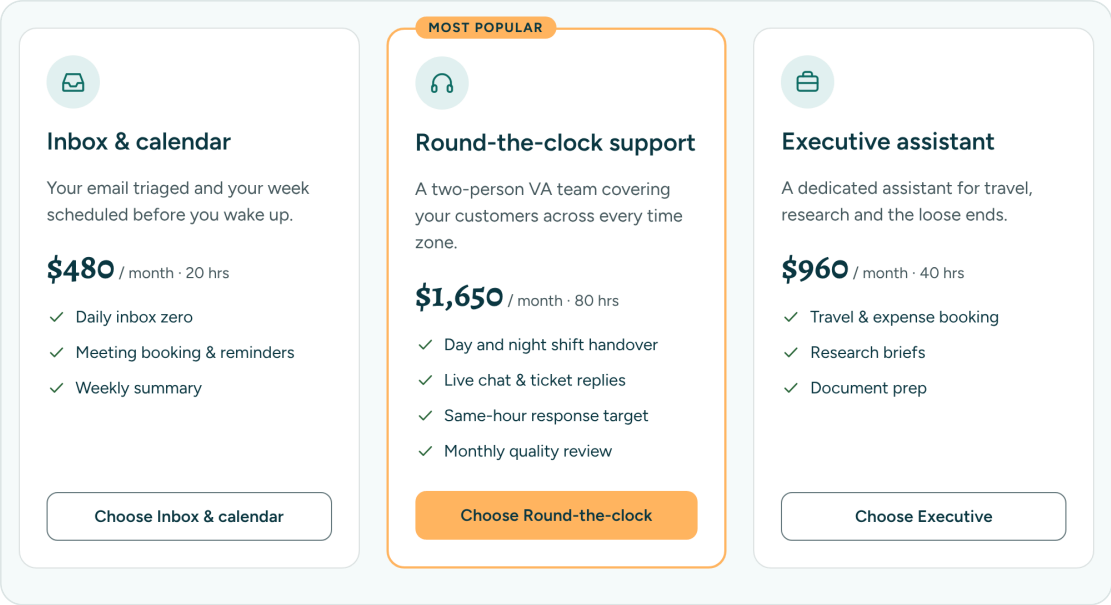
- 4–8 logos, 32px tall, company name as alt text

RULES

- Only clients who've agreed to be named; no carousels
- Wordmark placeholders are for designs only, never the live site

ServiceCard

One service offering — icon, title, description, price, features and a single CTA.



USING IT

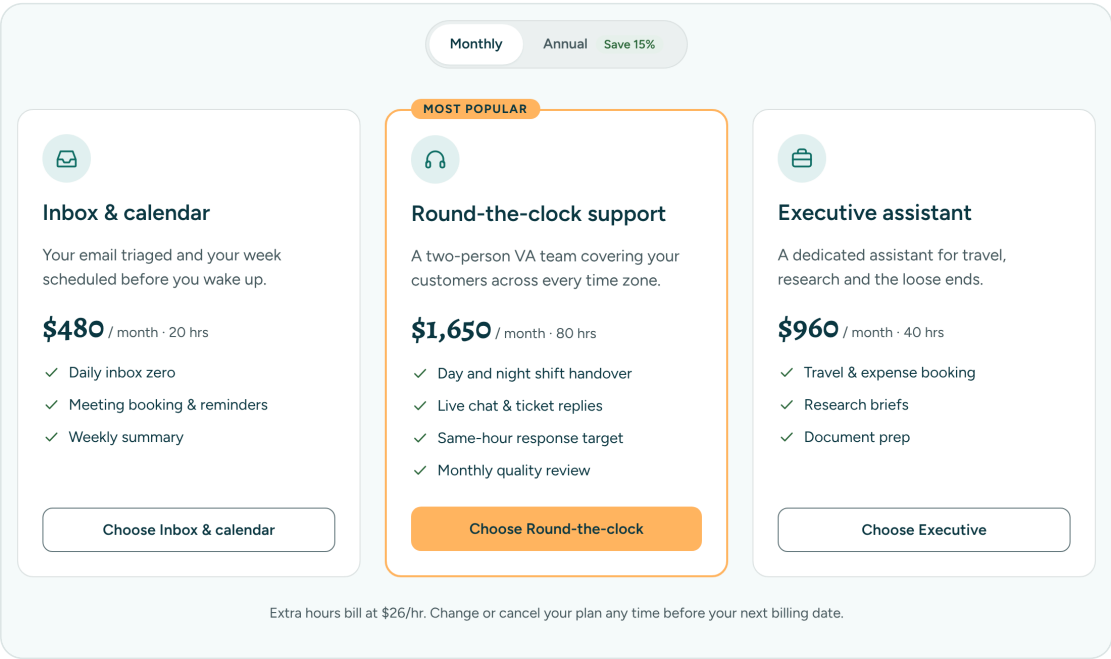
- 3–5 feature lines; `featured` on at most one card per grid

RULES

- CTA names the plan (“Choose Executive”); never the whole card as a link *and* a button inside
- One badge or decorative colour per card

PricingTable

A Monthly / Annual switch over the plan cards.



USING IT

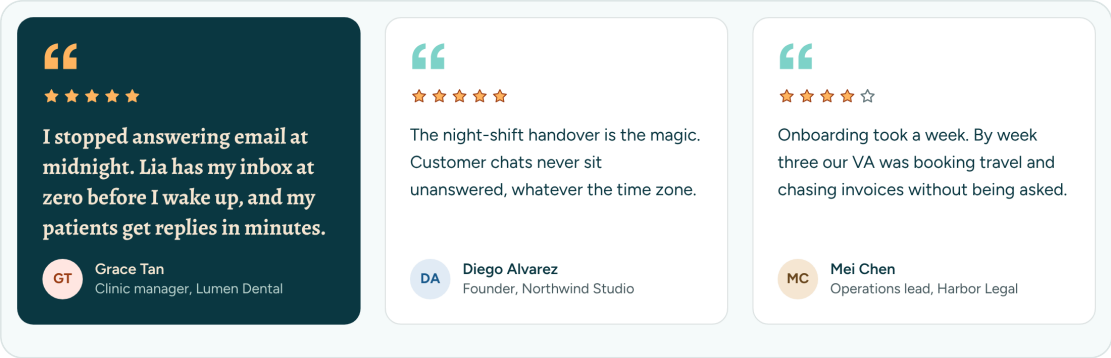
- Plans carry `priceMonthly`, `priceAnnual` and their units; `annualNote` (“Save 15%”)

RULES

- Three plans, the middle one featured
- Show per-month price in both modes so plans compare honestly
- Fine print in the footnote, not hidden in tooltips

Testimonial

Client quotes with name, role, company and optional rating; one can be featured.



USING IT

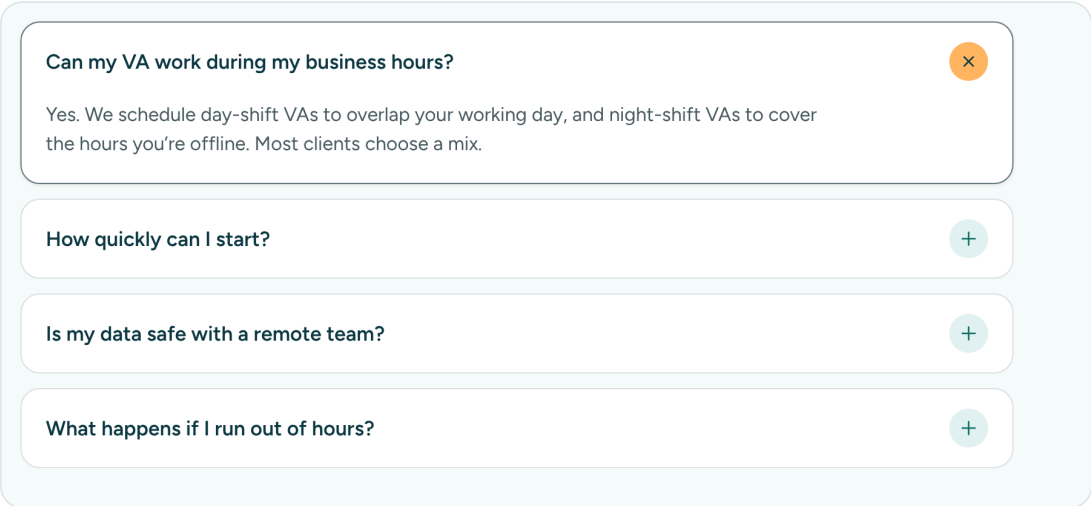
- TestimonialGrid lays them out: 1 column on phones, up to 3 on desktop

RULES

- Real words from real clients with written consent — trim, never rewrite
- One featured quote per page at most

FaqAccordion

Questions that expand to their answers, keeping long pages short.



USING IT

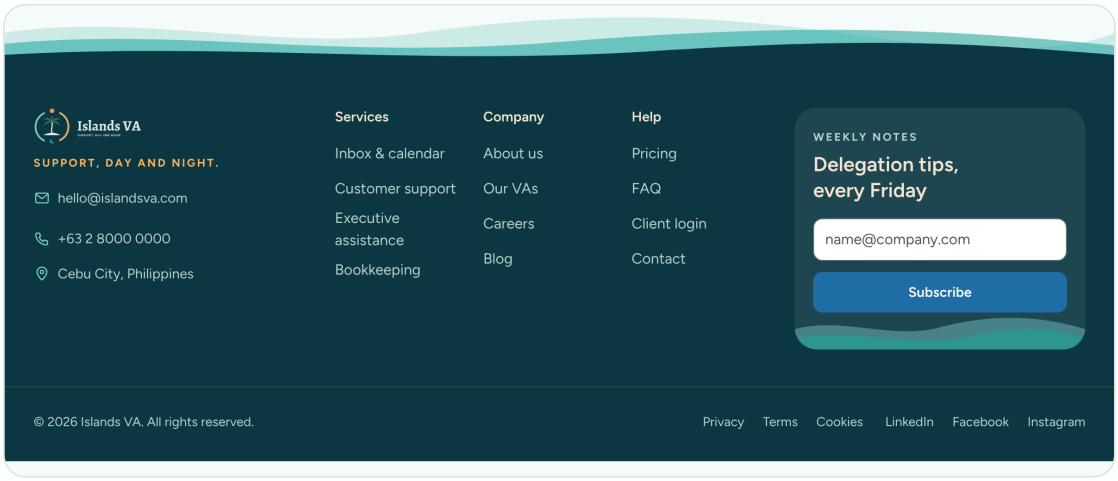
- 5–10 questions in the client's words; answers lead with the direct answer

RULES

- Each question is a heading with a button; closed answers stay findable by in-page search
- Add FAQPage structured data in Next.js

Footer

The site footer on deep teal, rising on a three-layer wave.



USING IT

- Night lockup, tagline, contact lines, three link columns, optional newsletter, legal row
- Social links as text labels (LinkedIn, Facebook) rather than brand icons

RULES

- Same in both themes (fixed brand hues); all text ≥7:1 on the deep ground
- Each link column is a `nav` labelled by its heading

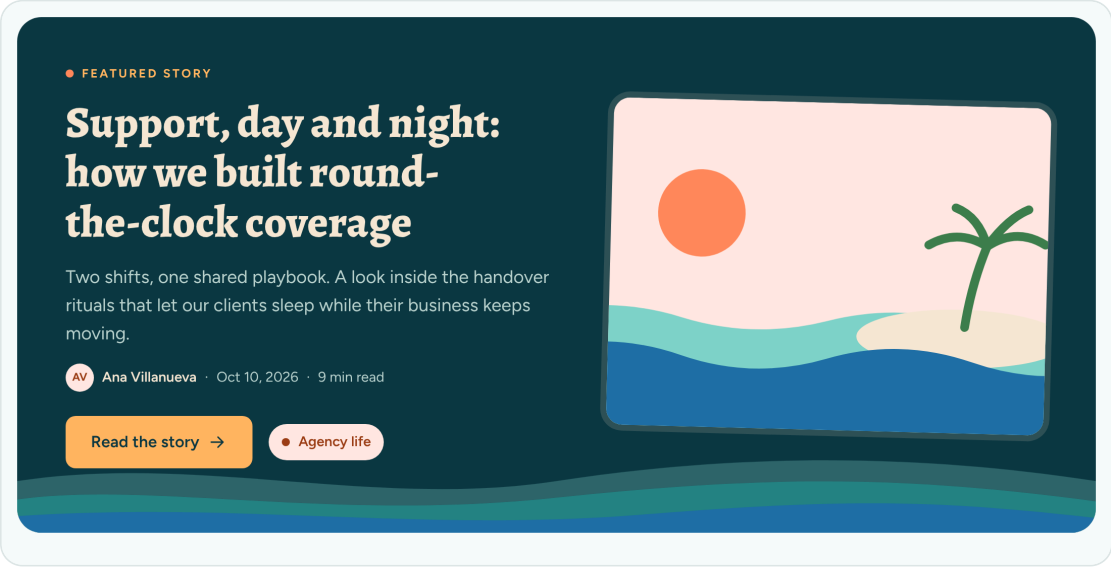
COMPONENTS

Blog

The tropical extension: lively colour, enterprise structure.

FeaturedPost

The banner for the one story the blog leads with.



USING IT

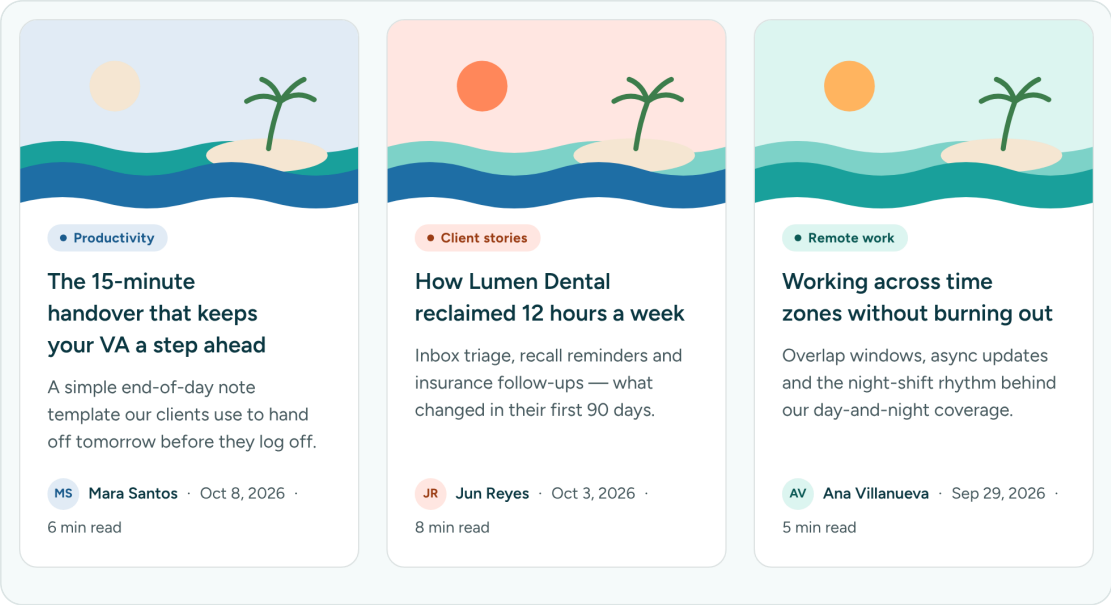
- `headingLevel={1}` when it's the page's main heading; otherwise h2
- Without an image it draws an illustrated cover in the post's tone

RULES

- Its CTA is the page's single primary; rotate weekly, never a carousel
- No text over the cover

PostCard

An article teaser where the whole card is one link (the title).



USING IT

- Category + tone, title, excerpt (clamped to 3 lines), author, date, read time
- Grid: 1 column at 360px, 2 beside the sidebar, 3 full width

RULES

- Hover: lift 4px, wave edge sweeps, cover waves drift, sunrise underline
- No extra links or buttons inside a card; titles must make sense out of context

TagChip

Category and tag labels in four tropical tones.



USING IT

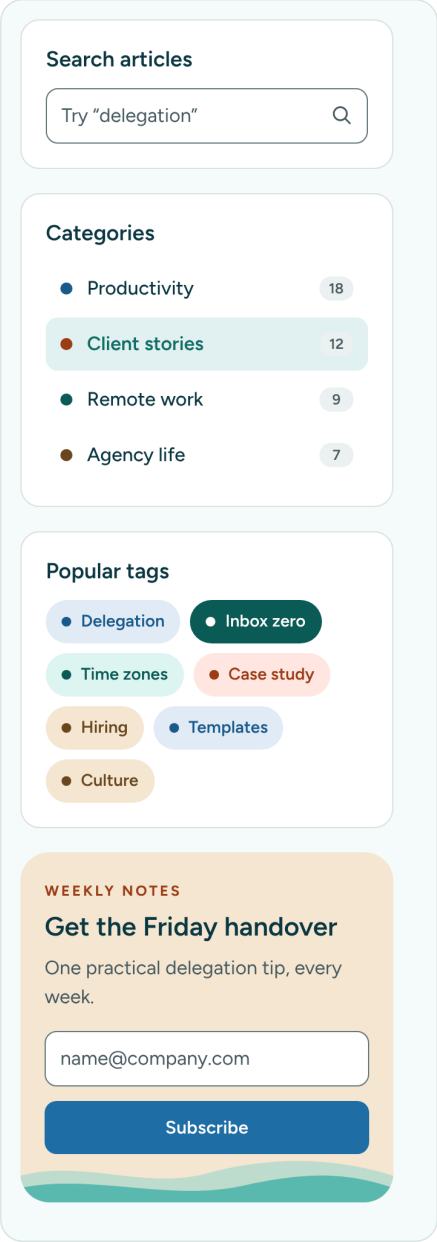
- lagoon: remote work · coral: client stories · sand: agency life · ocean: productivity

RULES

- One tone per category, everywhere; map new categories onto the four — never a fifth colour

BlogSidebar

Search, categories with counts, tag cloud and a newsletter panel.



USING IT

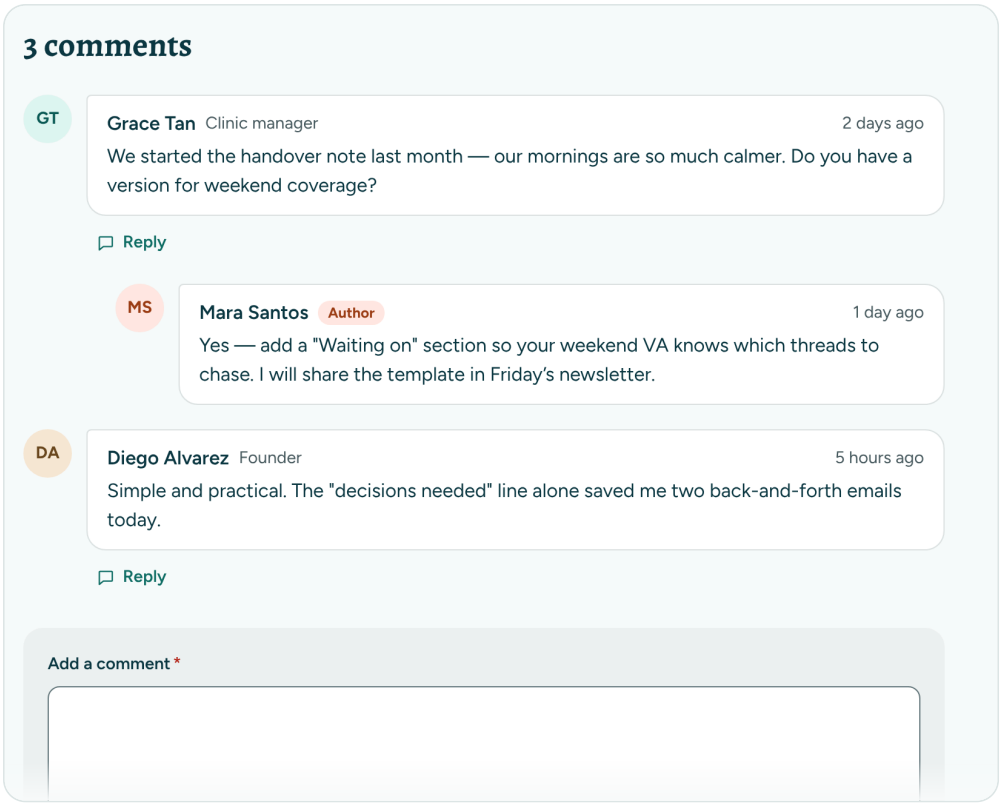
- Sticky 300px column from 1024px; below that it follows the posts

RULES

- Search is a labelled `role="search"` form; the active category is `aria-current`

CommentThread

Speech-bubble comments with an Author badge, one level of replies and a clear form.



USING IT

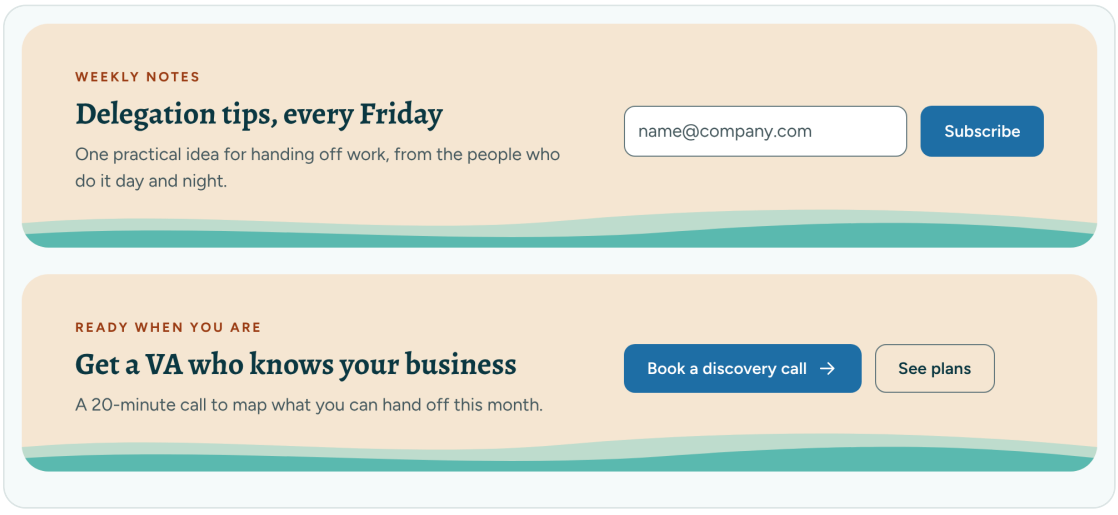
- `onSubmit(text, parentId)` → Server Action that validates, rate-limits and moderates

RULES

- Render bodies as text, never HTML
- Replies nest one level only — deeper threads are unreadable on phones

CtaBand

A warm sand band with a lagoon wave for newsletter sign-up or booking a call.



USING IT

- Links mode or newsletter mode (email field + ocean Subscribe); `compact` for the sidebar

RULES

- One full band per page; use `variant: 'ocean'` when a sunrise primary is already showing

PUTTING IT TOGETHER

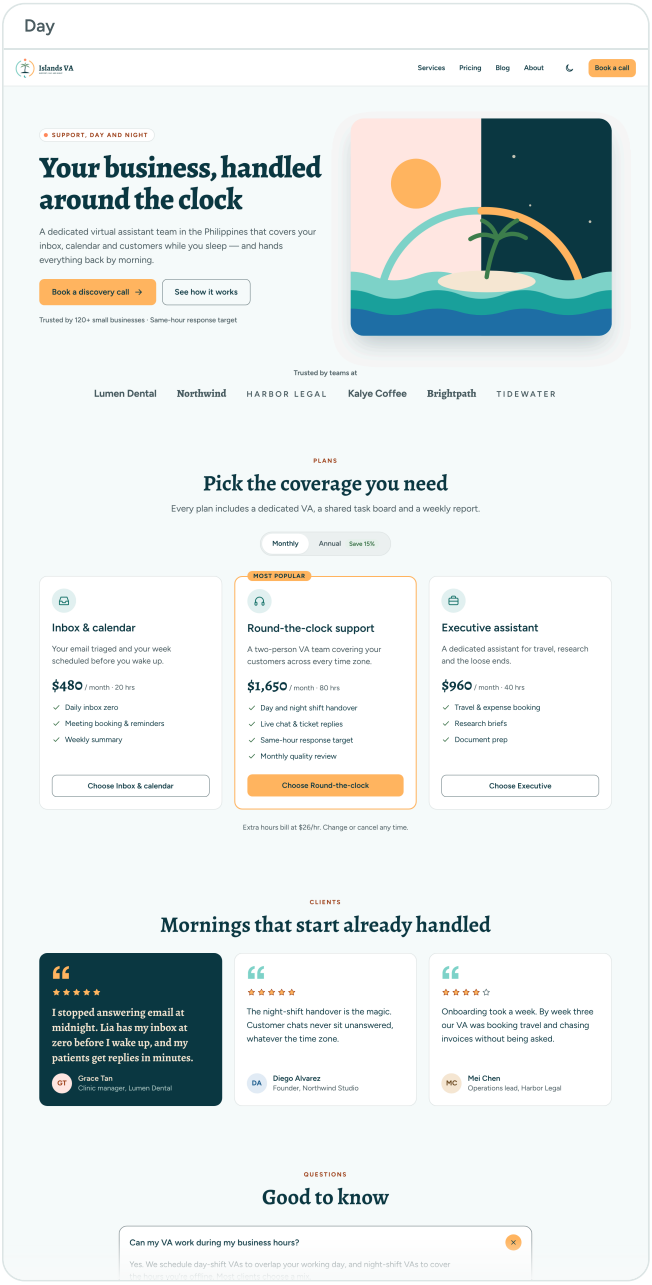
Page examples

Three reference pages built entirely from the system. Open them in the live system to try the theme switch and interactions.

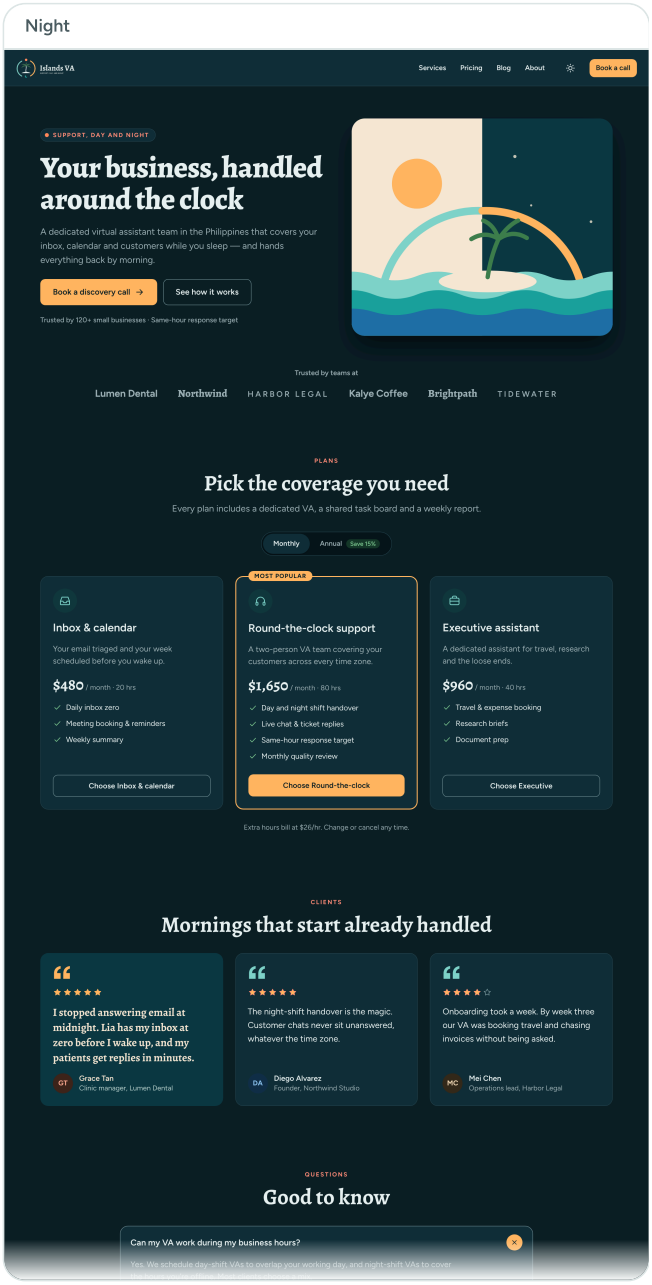
Landing page

NavBar · Hero · LogoStrip · PricingTable · TestimonialGrid · FaqAccordion · CtaBand · Footer

Day



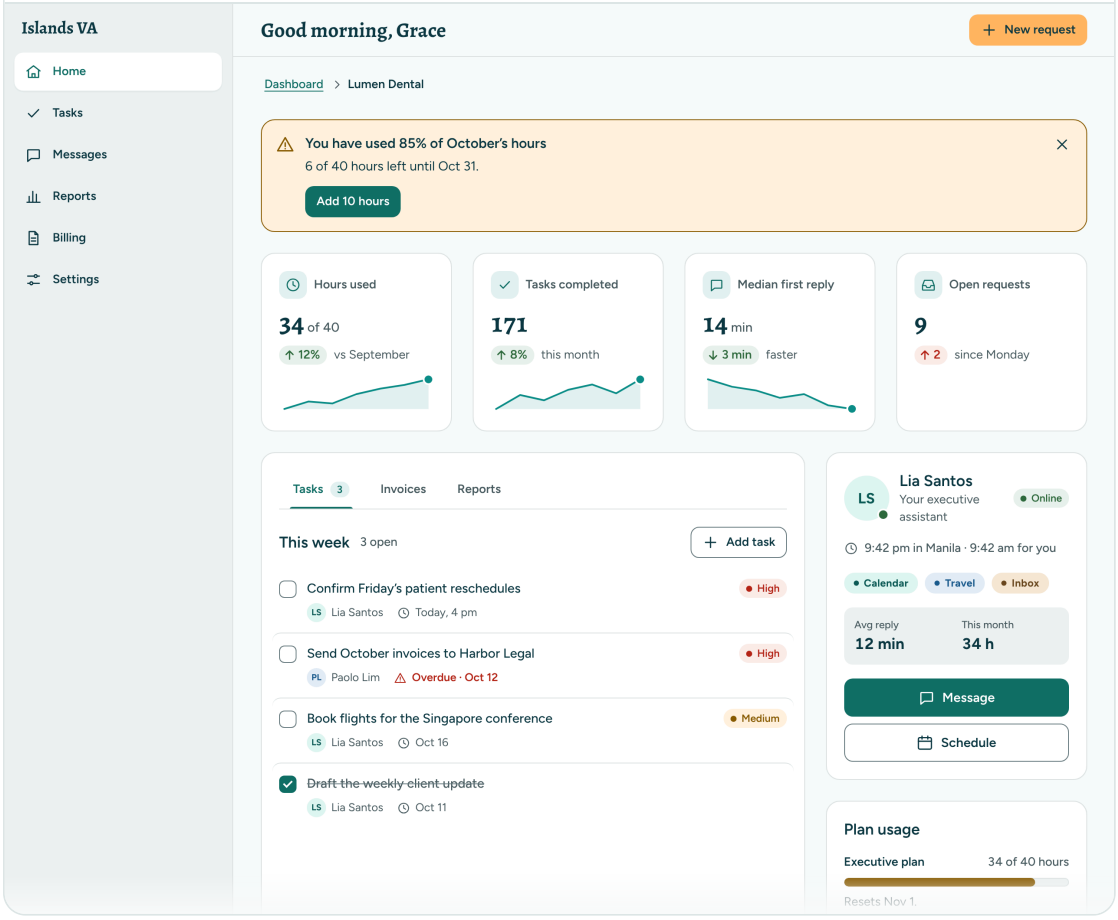
Night



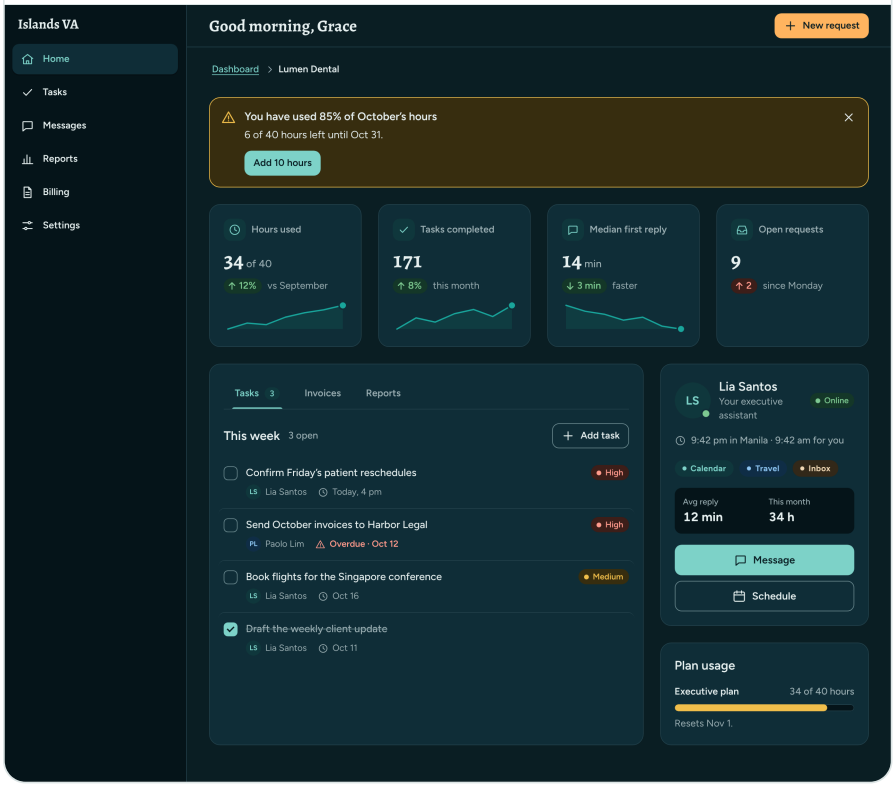
Client dashboard

DashboardShell · Breadcrumbs · Alert · StatCard · Tabs · TaskList · DataTable · ProfileCard · ProgressBar

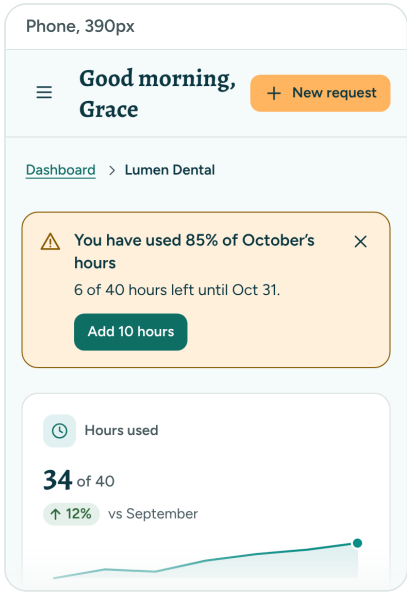
Day, desktop



Night, desktop

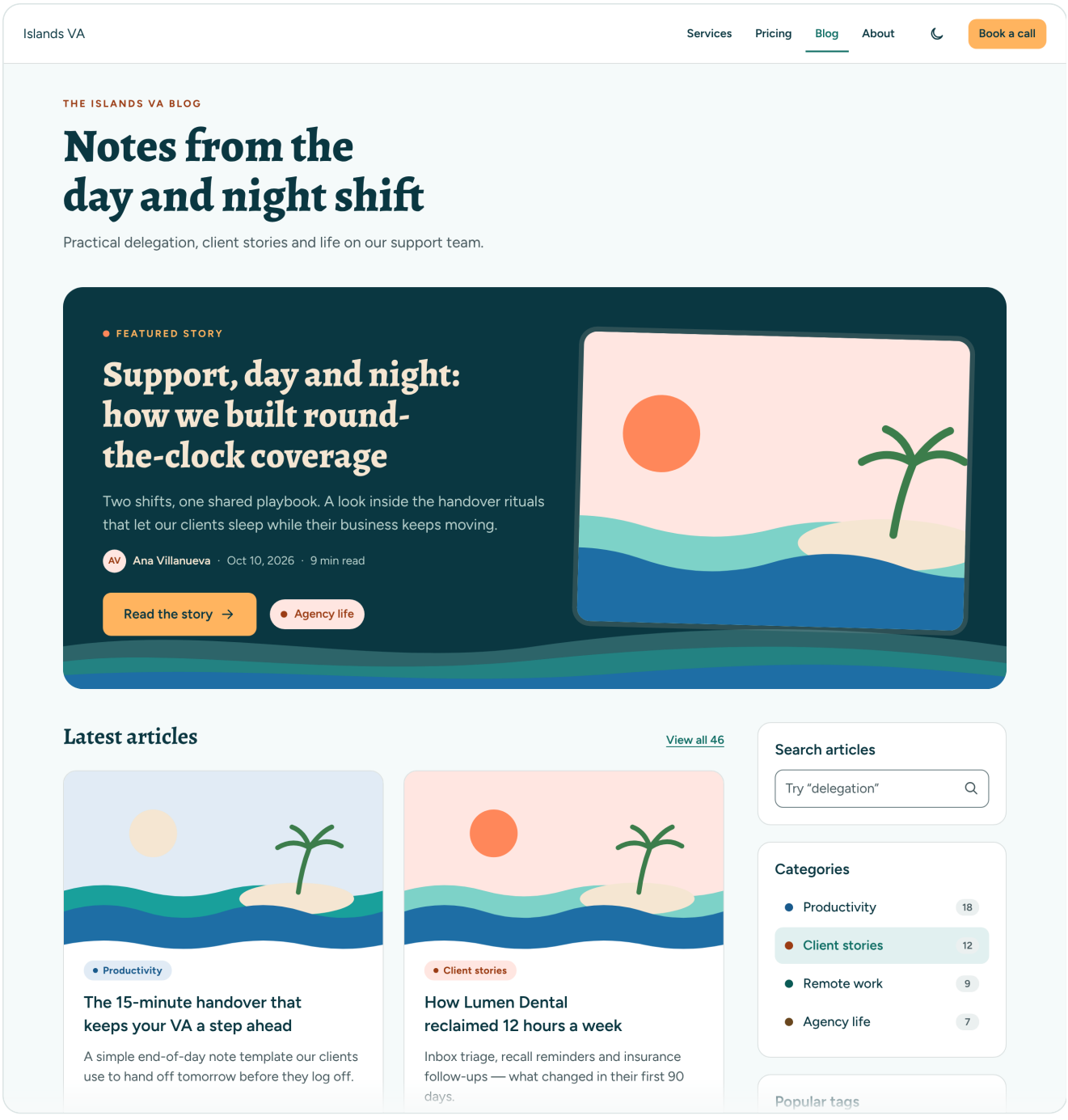


Phone, 390px



Blog

FeaturedPost · PostGrid · PostCard · BlogSidebar · CtaBand · WaveDivider · CommentThread



GUIDELINES

Data visualization

The client dashboard answers three questions at a glance: *How much of my plan have I used? What did my VA get done? Is anything waiting on me?* Most of that is numbers and lists, not charts. Reach for a chart only when the shape over time or the split between categories is the point.

Pick the form first

THE DATA'S JOB	USE
One headline number	**StatCard** (no chart), optionally with a sparkline for the trend's shape
How much of a limit is used	**ProgressBar**
Change over time, 1–3 series	Line chart
Parts of a whole across a few periods	Stacked bar (see **Chart colours**)
Comparing categories	Horizontal bar, one colour (`chart-1`), sorted by value
Records the client acts on	**DataTable** or **TaskList** — never a chart

Never a pie with more than three slices, never a dual-axis chart, never 3D.

Colour

- **Categorical order is fixed:** `chart-1` teal, `chart-2` orange, `chart-3` ocean, `chart-4` green, `chart-5` violet, `chart-6` rose. Assign in order and keep a series' colour when filters remove others. A seventh category folds into "Other" (`chart-other`).
- The order is validated, not chosen by eye: every neighbouring pair stays distinguishable under protanopia and deuteranopia (ΔE ≥ 13 in Day, ≥ 14.6 in Night, OKLab ×100), every colour clears 3:1 against `surface-card` , and Night uses its own darker-chroma steps rather than an automatic flip.
- Scatter and other charts where any two marks can touch: use only `chart-1` and `chart-2` ; beyond that, split into small multiples.
- One-series charts use `chart-1` only. Magnitude (heatmaps) uses one hue — teal — from light to dark.
- **Status colours are reserved** for state (success, warning, danger) and always travel with an icon and a word. Never use them as "series 4".
- Text never wears a series colour: values, labels and legends stay in `ink` / `ink-muted` ; a coloured key beside the label carries identity.

Marks and anatomy

- Lines 2px with round joins; bars with 4px rounded data ends and a 2px surface gap between stacked segments; markers ≥ 8px with a 2px `surface-card` ring.
- Gridlines `chart-grid` , horizontal only; axis labels `caption` in `ink-muted` ; the chart title is a plain `h3` that says what's measured ("VA hours by task type, last four months").
- Legend above the plot whenever there are two or more series; direct labels on up to four lines.

Interaction

- Every chart has a hover layer: crosshair and tooltip on lines, a per-mark tooltip on bars. Tooltips use `surface-inverse` .
- Filters (date range, VA, task type) sit in one row above the charts and apply to every chart on the page.
- Every chart has a data table equivalent — visually hidden or behind a "View as table" toggle — so screen-reader users get the numbers.

Numbers

- Tabular figures everywhere numbers align (`font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums` , built into StatCard, DataTable and ProgressBar).
- Hours to one decimal only when under 10; money with currency and thousands separators; dates as "Oct 13" in tables and "Oct 6–12" for ranges, in the client's time zone.
- Deltas say what better means: "3 min faster" beats "−3".

Next.js notes

- Fetch dashboard data in Server Components through the data access layer (session check first), cache per client with `'use cache'` + `cacheTag('client:<id>:stats')`, and revalidate the tag when a VA logs hours.
- StatCard, ProgressBar, DataTable (read-only) and ProfileCard can render on the server; TaskList, sortable/selectable DataTable, Tabs and DropdownMenu are client components.
- Stream slow panels behind `<Suspense fallback={<SkeletonCard />}>` so the stat row paints first.
- For full charts, a library such as Recharts or visx works; feed it `var(--chart-1)` … from the tokens so themes switch without re-rendering.

GUIDELINES

Feedback & navigation patterns

Clients hand Islands VA their inbox and their customers, so the product has to say clearly what's happening — calmly, in plain words, and without making anyone hunt for it.

Which message component?

SITUATION	USE	EXAMPLE
The user just did something and it worked	**Toast** (success)	"Task assigned to Lia" + Undo
Something needs attention until it's fixed	**Alert** (warning / danger) in the page	"Your card was declined. Update it to keep your VA hours running."
Context for a whole page or section	**Alert** (info)	"Your VA is on the night shift this week"
A field is wrong	Field error on **TextField** / **Select**	"Choose a start date to continue."
A must-answer decision	**Modal** (`alertdialog`)	"Cancel your plan?"
A row's state	**Badge**	Active · Near limit · Payment overdue
Nothing to show yet	**EmptyState**	"No tasks yet" + Add a task
Content is loading	**Skeleton** (after ~300ms)	Card-shaped placeholders
Usage against a limit	**ProgressBar**	"34 of 40 hours"

Rules shared by all of them:

- Status always shows as icon + word + colour, never colour alone. Warning and danger are announced immediately (`role="alert"`); everything else politely.
- Say what happened, then what to do. No "Oops", no exclamation marks, no blame.
- Never stack more than one alert of the same tone; never show a toast for an error the user must fix.

Navigation

- **Top NavBar** for the marketing site; **DashboardShell sidebar** for the app's main sections (up to 7).
- **Tabs** switch views of the *same* object (a client's Overview / Tasks / Invoices). If a tab needs its own URL, render links with `aria-current` and keep the look.
- **Breadcrumbs** on pages two or more levels deep; they collapse to parent + current on phones.
- **Pagination** for long lists; prefer real links (`?page=3`) so the back button and search engines work. Use "Load more" only for browsing feeds like the blog.
- **DropdownMenu** for actions (row actions, export, account); **Select** for choosing a value; links for going somewhere.
- **Stepper** for flows of 3–6 screens (onboarding, hiring a VA); save progress at each step.

Keyboard

Every component here follows its WAI-ARIA pattern: tabs and menus move with arrow keys and Home/End, Escape closes menus and tooltips and returns focus, and focus is always visible (`focus-ring` , 2px at 2px offset).

GUIDELINES

Accessibility checklist

Every screen passes this before release. Automated checks (axe in CI, Lighthouse ≥ 95) catch about a third of issues — the manual rows matter.

Perceivable

- [ ] Text contrast ≥ 4.5:1 (≥ 3:1 for 24px+ or 19px+ bold) **in Day and Night**. Approved pairs: `ink` / `ink-muted` / `ink-accent` / `link` on `surface-page`, `surface-card`, `surface-sunken`; `on-action-primary` on `action-primary`; `on-action-secondary` on `action-secondary`; `status-*` on `status-*-bg` and `surface-card`. (1.4.3)
- [ ] Never set text in `brand-lagoon`, `brand-sunrise`, `brand-sun` or `brand-reef` on light grounds. (1.4.3)
- [ ] Control boundaries, focus rings, toggle tracks and meaningful icons ≥ 3:1 (`border-strong`, `focus-ring`). (1.4.11)
- [ ] Colour is never the only signal: status pills, errors and chart series carry an icon, word, pattern or direct label. (1.4.1)
- [ ] Every image has appropriate `alt`; decorative ones `alt=""`; charts have a text summary or data table. (1.1.1)
- [ ] Content reflows at 320px wide with no horizontal scroll (except data tables, which scroll inside their own region). (1.4.10)
- [ ] Text resizes to 200% and survives custom text spacing without clipping — no fixed heights on text containers. (1.4.4, 1.4.12)
- [ ] Info conveyed by layout is in the markup: real headings in order, lists, tables with `<th scope>`, fieldsets with legends. (1.3.1)
- [ ] Form inputs have `autoComplete` for personal data. (1.3.5)
- [ ] Works in portrait and landscape. (1.3.4)

Operable

- [ ] Everything works by keyboard alone, in a logical order; no keyboard traps except the intentional, escapable Modal trap. (2.1.1, 2.1.2, 2.4.3)
- [ ] Visible focus on every focusable element — 2px `focus-ring`, 2px offset; never `outline: none` without a replacement. (2.4.7)
- [ ] "Skip to main content" link is the first focusable element; pages use `<header>`, `<nav>`, `<main>`, `<footer>` landmarks. (2.4.1)
- [ ] Unique, descriptive `<title>` per route via the Metadata API ("Pricing · Islands VA"). (2.4.2)
- [ ] Link and button text makes sense out of context (CTA names the plan). (2.4.4)
- [ ] Touch targets ≥ 44×44px (`tap-target`). (2.5.5 is AAA; we adopt it as a floor.)
- [ ] Session timeouts warn at least 2 minutes ahead and let users extend; no time limits on forms. (2.2.1)
- [ ] Nothing flashes more than 3 times a second; auto-moving content (testimonial carousels) has pause and stops on focus/hover. (2.3.1, 2.2.2)
- [ ] Animations respect `prefers-reduced-motion`.

Understandable

- [ ] `<html lang="en">` (and `lang` on any passage in another language, e.g. Filipino). (3.1.1, 3.1.2)
- [ ] Every input has a visible `<label>`; required fields are indicated in text and with `required`. (3.3.2)
- [ ] Errors are identified in text, linked with `aria-describedby`, and say how to fix them; on submit, focus moves to an error summary. (3.3.1, 3.3.3)
- [ ] Bookings, payments and cancellations can be reviewed or undone before they are final. (3.3.4)
- [ ] Navigation and component names are consistent across pages; nothing changes context on focus or on input without warning. (3.2.1–3.2.4)

Robust

- [ ] Native elements first (`button`, `a`, `select`, `input type=checkbox`); ARIA only where HTML has no equivalent (`role="switch"`, `aria-expanded`, `aria-current`, `aria-modal`). (4.1.2)
- [ ] Status messages (saved, sent, errors from server actions) announced via a polite `aria-live` region without moving focus. (4.1.3)
- [ ] Valid, unique IDs (use React `useId`).

Manual test pass (per release)

1. Keyboard-only walkthrough of the key journeys: book a call, sign in, add a task, change a setting.

2. Screen readers: VoiceOver + Safari (iOS and macOS), NVDA + Chrome or Firefox (Windows).
3. 200% zoom and 320px viewport.
4. Both themes, plus Windows High Contrast / `forced-colors`.
5. Re-run axe on every new component preview.

FOR DEVELOPERS

Next.js implementation

How the system is wired into a Next.js App Router codebase. Version-specific APIs are noted; check the Next.js docs for the version you run.

Folder structure

```
src/
  app/
    layout.tsx                # <html lang data-theme>, fonts, skip link, ThemeScript
    globals.css               # @import tokens.css + base
    (marketing)/              # public, statically rendered
      layout.tsx              # NavBar + Footer
      page.tsx
      services/[slug]/page.tsx
      pricing/page.tsx
    (auth)/login/page.tsx
    (dashboard)/              # protected route group
      layout.tsx              # DashboardShell, session check
      overview/page.tsx
      tasks/page.tsx
    @modal/(.)services/[slug]/page.tsx   # intercepted modal route
    api/                      # route handlers (webhooks only)
  components/
    ui/                       # design-system primitives — no data fetching
      button.tsx  nav-bar.tsx  service-card.tsx  modal.tsx
      text-field.tsx  select.tsx  checkbox.tsx  toggle.tsx
      dashboard-shell.tsx  grid.tsx  icon.tsx  index.ts
    features/                 # composed, domain-aware (BookingForm, TaskTable)
  lib/
    auth.ts  dal.ts           # session + data-access layer (server-only)
    validation/               # zod schemas shared by client and server
  styles/tokens.css           # generated from tokens.json
```

Rules: `components/ui` never imports from `features` or `lib/dal`; pages compose features; server-only modules start with `import "server-only"`.

Tokens

- `tokens.json` is the source of truth; generate `styles/tokens.css` from it in CI (Style Dictionary or a 30-line script). Themes are `:root, [data-theme="day"]` and `[data-theme="night"]` blocks of CSS custom properties.
- Tailwind (v4): map tokens with `@theme inline { --color-ink: var(--ink); --color-surface-card: var(--surface-card); --radius-lg: var(--radius-lg); … }` so `bg-surface-card text-ink rounded-lg` follow the theme automatically. Don't hard-code hex values in classes.
- No theme flash: read the `theme` cookie in the root layout and render `<html data-theme={theme ?? undefined}>`; when no cookie exists, a tiny inline script sets it from `prefers-color-scheme` before paint. The NavBar switch writes the cookie through a server action.

Fonts

```
import { Alegreya, Figtree } from "next/font/google";
const display = Alegreya({ subsets: ["latin"], weight: ["700", "800"], variable: "--font-display", display: "swap" });
const sans = Figtree({ subsets: ["latin"], variable: "--font-sans", display: "swap" });
// <html className={`${display.variable} ${sans.variable}`}>
```

`next/font` self-hosts the files (no request to Google at runtime), preloads them and applies size-adjusted fallbacks to avoid layout shift.

Rendering & performance

- **Server Components by default.** Only interactive leaves are `"use client"` (Button with handlers, NavBar menu, Modal, Toggle). Pass server data in as props.

- **Static first:** marketing pages are statically generated; service pages use `generateStaticParams`. Revalidate CMS content by tag on publish (`revalidateTag("services")`) rather than on a timer. On versions with Cache Components, mark cacheable data functions with `"use cache"` + `cacheTag` / `cacheLife`.
- **Streaming:** wrap each dashboard panel in `<Suspense>` with a skeleton the same size as the panel; add `loading.tsx` per route segment.
- **Lazy loading:** `next/dynamic` for heavy client widgets (charts, rich-text editor, the booking calendar), `next/image` lazy by default, third-party scripts (chat widget, analytics) via `next/script` with `strategy="lazyOnload"`.
- **Links:** `next/link` prefetches visible routes; keep the dashboard nav as links so transitions are instant.
- **Budgets (CI-enforced):** LCP < 2.5s, INP < 200ms, CLS < 0.1 on a mid-range phone; first-load JS for marketing routes < 120 KB gzipped. Track with `@next/bundle-analyzer` and real-user Web Vitals (`useReportWebVitals`).
- **Caching headers:** static assets are immutable and fingerprinted by Next; never cache authenticated HTML at the CDN — dashboard routes are dynamic (`cookies()` usage opts them out).

Security-conscious UI patterns

Protected routes

- Optimistic redirect in `proxy.ts` (`middleware.ts` before Next.js 16): no session cookie → redirect to `/login?next=<path>` (validate `next` is a same-site relative path to avoid open redirects).
- **Authorise again where data is read:** every page, server action and route handler calls `verifySession()` from the data-access layer. Middleware/proxy alone is not an authorization boundary.
- Session cookies: `HttpOnly`, `Secure`, `SameSite=Lax`, short-lived with rotation. Never put tokens in `localStorage`.
- Role checks hide UI *and* are enforced on the server (an assistant can't reach billing just because the button is hidden).

Safe forms

- Submit through **server actions** with `useActionState`; show `loading` on the submit Button via the pending state (prevents double-submit).
- Validate with one shared Zod schema: client for fast feedback, server as the authority. Return field errors to the same `error` props; never echo raw server errors or stack traces.
- Server actions are public POST endpoints — check session, ownership and input in every one. Next.js compares Origin and Host for actions; configure `serverActions.allowedOrigins` only for known proxies.
- Public forms (contact, booking): rate-limit by IP + email, add a hidden honeypot field and a time-to-submit check, and use a privacy-friendly challenge (e.g. Turnstile) only after suspicion.
- Login and reset flows use generic messages ("If that email has an account, we've sent a link") to avoid account enumeration; support passkeys/2FA (`autoComplete="one-time-code"`).
- Mask sensitive values (API keys, card last-4 only) and require re-authentication before changing email, password or payout details.
- Never render user content with `dangerouslySetInnerHTML`; if rich text is unavoidable, sanitise server-side with an allow-list.

Headers (set in `next.config` `headers()` or proxy): a nonce-based Content-Security-Policy, `Strict-Transport-Security`, `X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff`, `Referrer-Policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin`, `Permissions-Policy` disabling camera/mic/geolocation unless used, and `frame-ancestors 'none'` in the CSP.

Secrets: only `NEXT_PUBLIC_*` variables reach the browser — keep everything else server-side; use the `server-only` package on modules that touch secrets.

Scalability

- Components are presentational and token-driven; variants via props (`variant`, `size`), not new components. Add a variant only when it appears in two or more places.
- Each `ui` component ships with: types, a story or preview, a README entry here, and an axe test. Visual regression (Playwright screenshots) in both themes.
- Feature folders own their data and server actions; shared types live in `lib/`.
- Version the design system with the app; a change to `tokens.json` triggers token regeneration and visual-diff review.

PROCESS

Working with the system

The system stays useful only if it stays the single source. A few habits keep it that way.

Before you design or build

- Check the live system for an existing component or variant first
- Use tokens, never hex values, in designs and code
- Design and review every screen in Day **and** Night, and at 360px
- Run the accessibility checklist before a screen ships

Proposing a change

- Add a variant only when it's needed in two or more places
- New components ship with types, a preview, guidelines and an accessibility check
- Token changes regenerate `tokens.css` and get a visual review in both themes
- Record what changed and why in the version notes

Where things live

Live system	https://claude.ai/artifact/Ha5kSyvZ7axkKvVYjupvpK
Tokens	`tokens.json` (source of truth) → generated `styles/tokens.css`
Components	`src/components/ui/*` in the Next.js app; previews and guidelines in the live system
Types	`components/index.d.ts` — every prop, documented
Logos	Logos group in the live system (day, night, mark, original)
Contact	hello@islandsva.com



SUPPORT, DAY AND NIGHT.